

The impulsive close–encounter cutoff is exactly

$$b_{90} = G(m_i + m_*)/V^2:$$

a self–contained proof

July 10, 2026

Abstract

We prove that, for a point–mass perturber, the ultraviolet (close–encounter) divergence of the impulsive kick covariance of a binary is regularized by the 90° –deflection radius $b_{90,i} = G(m_i + m_*)/V^2$ *with no free constant*, and that the resulting Coulomb logarithm and the accompanying $\mathcal{O}(1)$ constants are the exact leading–order result in the impulsive limit $\eta = b_{90}/r \rightarrow 0$. The proof combines the exact two–body (Rutherford) kick, a clean single–body self–energy identity, an exact variation–of–parameters (osculating–elements) treatment of the close encounter perturbed by the companion, and a matched decomposition of the impact–parameter plane whose intermediate scale cancels identically. Every step is reduced either to an explicit computation or to elementary quantitative estimates (Gronwall bounds on the incoming leg, exit–map measure estimates for close and sequential approaches — including the lensing caustic that the companion produces at its Einstein radius $\mathcal{O}(\sqrt{b_{90}r})$ when the binary is nearly aligned with the flight direction, and the rainbow–scattering fold of a heavy perturber, whose lab–frame deflection off body i is capped at $\arcsin(m_i/m_*)$ — and a crude but sufficient dispersal estimate for the rare exchange–capture trajectories, on which no asymptotic kick exists); the only inputs kept outside the argument are the frozen–binary approximation itself and Newtonian gravity. Two physical points deserve emphasis. First, the recoil of the struck body during the encounter is essential: pinning the binary components in place would change the cutoff to Gm_i/V^2 ; it is the recoil that produces the reduced–mass scale $G(m_i + m_*)/V^2$. Second, the companion deflects the perturber by an $\mathcal{O}(1)$ amount *per trajectory* even in the limit; this survives the impact–parameter integration only as an $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$ correction (numerically consistent with a gravitational–focusing effect), because to leading order it is an area–preserving relabeling of the impact–parameter plane. The proven error bound is a positive power of η ; the numerics show the true rate is $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$ with no constant offset, directly excluding any rescaling $b_{90,i} \rightarrow \alpha b_{90,i}$.

Contents

1	Setup, conventions, and the precise claim	2
1.1	The encounter: the frozen–binary model, stated carefully	2
1.2	The kick covariance	3
1.3	The closed form to be proved	3
1.4	Assumptions and scope	5
2	The exact single–body encounter	5
3	Decomposition of the binary integral	7

4	The near region: the close encounter is two-body up to controlled errors	13
4.1	Osculating elements and the exact variation-of-parameters identity	13
4.2	The deflection map, now with proofs	14
4.3	Near-region self-energy	16
5	The far region: straight lines, the upper scale, and the anisotropy	17
6	Assembly: proof of Theorem 1	19
6.1	The trace, the anisotropy, and the error tally	19
6.2	Angular and speed averages give the constants	20
6.3	Why no constant can hide	20
7	The surviving correction: size, sign, and interpretation	21
7.1	What survives at $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$	21
7.2	Direct three-body tests	21
8	What is proved, and what is not	22
A	Incoming-leg regularity of the Kepler flow	23

This note accompanies the paper “Evolution of Binaries Under Stochastic Perturbations” [1], where the result proven here is used; notation follows that paper. The numerical checks quoted below are the scripts `exact_deflection_check.py`, `three_body_check.py` and `deflection_map_check.py`, released alongside this note in the same directory (`regularization-exactness/`) of the paper’s code repository; the companion script `cutoff_check.py` additionally documents the Fourier-space origin of the two per-body cutoffs and the scheme dependence of alternative regulators.

1 Setup, conventions, and the precise claim

1.1 The encounter: the frozen-binary model, stated carefully

A binary has components of masses m_1, m_2 (total $m = m_1 + m_2$) initially at rest at positions $\vec{s}_1, \vec{s}_2$ with separation $\vec{r} = \vec{s}_2 - \vec{s}_1$, $|\vec{r}| = r$. A perturber of mass m_* arrives from infinity with velocity $\vec{V}$ ($|\vec{V}| = V$) and asymptotic impact parameter $\vec{b}$ lying in the plane Π_V through the centre of mass perpendicular to $\hat{V} = \vec{V}/V$.

The dynamics is Newtonian gravity among the three bodies *with the internal binary force switched off*: the perturber is accelerated by both components, each component is accelerated by the perturber, and the components do not act on each other,

$$\ddot{\vec{x}}_* = - \sum_{i=1,2} \frac{Gm_i(\vec{x}_* - \vec{x}_i)}{|\vec{x}_* - \vec{x}_i|^3}, \quad \ddot{\vec{x}}_i = \frac{Gm_*(\vec{x}_* - \vec{x}_i)}{|\vec{x}_* - \vec{x}_i|^3} \quad (i = 1, 2). \quad (1)$$

This is the impulse approximation: the internal force is what makes the binary orbit on the slow time scale, and freezing it isolates the effect of one fast passage; its leading correction (the binary moving during the passage) is the standard adiabatic correction, of relative order $Gm/(rV^2) = \mathcal{O}(\eta)$ [2], the same order as the corrections we track, and is outside the scope of this note (assumption (A1) below). The net kicks are $\Delta \vec{v}_i \equiv \vec{v}_i(+\infty) - \vec{v}_i(-\infty) = \vec{v}_i(+\infty)$, and the change of the binary’s internal (relative) velocity is $\Delta \vec{v} = \Delta \vec{v}_1 - \Delta \vec{v}_2$ (this is minus the change of $d(\vec{s}_2 - \vec{s}_1)/dt$; the sign is irrelevant for the second moments studied here).

Remark 1 (Recoil is essential: pinned bodies would give a different cutoff). *One might be tempted to freeze the binary by pinning the components, computing the perturber’s orbit in the fixed two-centre potential and reading off the would-be impulse $\Delta\vec{v}_i = Gm_* \int (\vec{x}_* - \vec{s}_i) |\vec{x}_* - \vec{s}_i|^{-3} dt$. That model gives a different answer. For a single pinned body the perturber’s orbit is a hyperbola with gravitational parameter Gm_i (the source does not participate in the reduced-mass dynamics), so $\tan(\Theta/2) = \tilde{b}_i/\beta$ with $\tilde{b}_i = Gm_i/V^2$, and by momentum bookkeeping $|\Delta\vec{v}_i|^2 = 4G^2m_*^2/[V^2(\beta^2 + \tilde{b}_i^2)]$: the close-encounter cutoff would be Gm_i/V^2 , not $G(m_i + m_*)/V^2$, an error of $\ln[(m_i + m_*)/m_i]$ in the Coulomb-log constant (vanishing only for $m_* \ll m_i$). In the correct model (1) the struck body recoils during the passage — by a displacement $\mathcal{O}(b_{90})$, the same order as the cutoff itself — and the relative m_* – m_i motion is the reduced-mass Kepler problem with parameter $G(m_i + m_*)$, which produces the literal $b_{90,i}$ of the theorem. Both statements are confirmed by direct integration in `deflection_map_check.py` (§7.2).*

We use throughout the 90° –deflection radii and the small parameter

$$b_{90,i} \equiv \frac{G(m_i + m_*)}{V^2}, \quad b_{90} \equiv \frac{G(m + m_*)}{V^2}, \quad \boxed{\eta \equiv \frac{b_{90}}{r} = \frac{G(m + m_*)}{rV^2}}. \quad (2)$$

The *impulsive limit* is $\eta \rightarrow 0$, realized e.g. by $V \rightarrow \infty$ at fixed binary. All of $b_{90,i}, b_{90}$ differ only by bounded mass factors; η is their common dimensionless smallness. Throughout, $C, c, \dots$ denote positive constants depending only on the mass ratios (never on η), whose value may change between displays.

1.2 The kick covariance

The local second-moment (diffusion) tensor of a bath of perturbers, number density n and isotropic velocity distribution g , is

$$\mathcal{Q}^{\alpha\beta}(r) = n \int d^3V V g(\vec{V}) \int_{\Pi_V} d^2b \Delta v^\alpha \Delta v^\beta = \text{diag}(Q_r, Q_t, Q_t), \quad (3)$$

the diagonal form following from isotropy of g ($\hat{r}$ being the only special direction). For a *point* perturber the inner d^2b integral is logarithmically ultraviolet divergent in the straight-line approximation: as $\vec{b}$ brings the perturber arbitrarily close to a body, the straight-line kick $\propto 1/b$ blows up. The physical content of this note is the precise value of the scale at which the exact dynamics (1) cuts off this divergence.

One definitional point must be fixed at the outset. For a point perturber there is an exceptional set $N \subset \Pi_V$ of impact parameters whose trajectory never disperses: the perturber is exchanged into a bound pair with one of the bodies, the other body carrying away the excess energy. On N the asymptotic kicks do not exist, and the inner integrals in (3) are understood over $\Pi_V \setminus N$. Lemma 7 bounds $\mu(N) = \mathcal{O}(\sqrt{\eta} b_{90}^2 \text{polylog})$ at generic orientations, far below the accuracy of any statement below; physically, a formally captured perturber is an artifact of the frozen-binary idealization (A1), since on the slow time scale the binary’s internal motion and later bath encounters disrupt any such marginally bound configuration.

1.3 The closed form to be proved

Fix $\vec{V}$ and do the d^2b integral first. Writing $\vec{y} \equiv (V/2Gm_*) \Delta\vec{v}$ and resolving the in-plane second moment along ($\perp$) and across ($\parallel$) the projected separation $r_\perp^\rightarrow = \vec{r} - (\vec{r} \cdot \hat{V})\hat{V}$ ($r_\perp = r \sin \theta$, $\cos \theta =$

$\hat{V} \cdot \hat{r}$), the result of the companion paper [1] is the in-plane tensor

$$\boxed{\mathcal{Y}_\perp + \mathcal{Y}_\parallel = 2\pi \ln \frac{r_\perp^2}{b_{90,1}b_{90,2}}, \quad \mathcal{Y}_\perp - \mathcal{Y}_\parallel = 2\pi} \quad (4)$$

(equivalently $\mathcal{Y}_\perp = \pi[\bar{L} + 1]$, $\mathcal{Y}_\parallel = \pi[\bar{L} - 1]$ with $\bar{L} = \ln[r_\perp^2/(b_{90,1}b_{90,2})]$), which after the elementary θ - and speed-averages (§6) gives

$$Q_r = \frac{8\pi}{3}C_Q(\mathcal{L} - \frac{2}{3}), \quad Q_t = \frac{8\pi}{3}C_Q(\mathcal{L} - \frac{8}{3}), \quad C_Q = G^2m_*^2n\langle V^{-1} \rangle, \quad (5)$$

with $\mathcal{L} = \ln[16\sigma^4r^2/(G^2(m_1 + m_*)(m_2 + m_*)) - 2\gamma_E]$ for a Maxwellian of dispersion σ . The boxed scales in (4) — the *literal* $b_{90,i}$ with unit coefficient inside the log, and the cutoff-free anisotropy constant 2π — are what fix the $\mathcal{O}(1)$ constants $-\frac{2}{3}$, $-\frac{8}{3}$ and the argument of $\mathcal{L}$. They are the object of the theorem.

One bookkeeping choice must be made precise before the theorem can be stated. In the straight-line sharp-cutoff scheme the kick is purely transverse (it lies in Π_V), so the in-plane sum $\mathcal{Y}_\perp + \mathcal{Y}_\parallel$ of (4) is at the same time the full trace of the second-moment tensor. In the exact dynamics the two differ at $\mathcal{O}(1)$: the genuine deflection also delivers a longitudinal kick (Lemma 1), which contributes π per body to the trace, while the exact in-plane components fall short of the sharp-cutoff value by the same π per body (the soft-core “ $\sqrt{e}$ ” discussed after Lemma 2). It is the *trace*,

$$\mathcal{T} \equiv \int_{\Pi_V} |\vec{y}|^2 d^2b \quad (\text{all three components of } \vec{y}), \quad (6)$$

that obeys the closed form of (4), and by Lemma 3 the pair (trace, in-plane anisotropy) is exactly what the θ - and speed-averages (46) require: how the trace splits between in-plane and longitudinal components is a traceless-quadrupole redistribution that cancels identically in Q_r and Q_t .

Theorem 1 (Exactness of the impulsive regularization). *Let $\mathcal{T}^{\text{exact}}$ and $(\mathcal{Y}_\perp - \mathcal{Y}_\parallel)^{\text{exact}}$ be computed from the exact frozen-binary three-body dynamics (1) for a point perturber — $\mathcal{T}$ the trace (6) and $\mathcal{Y}_\perp - \mathcal{Y}_\parallel$ the in-plane anisotropy, both integrals over $\Pi_V \setminus N$ (Lemma 7). Fix any $\alpha \in (0, \frac{1}{2})$. Then, at fixed V , uniformly over orientations with $\sin \theta \geq \eta^\alpha$,*

$$\mathcal{T}^{\text{exact}} = 2\pi \ln \frac{r_\perp^2}{b_{90,1}b_{90,2}} + o(1), \quad (\mathcal{Y}_\perp - \mathcal{Y}_\parallel)^{\text{exact}} = 2\pi + o(1), \quad (7)$$

where $o(1) \rightarrow 0$ as $\eta \rightarrow 0$ (indeed $\mathcal{O}(\eta^c)$ for an explicit $c > 0$; see §6.1). The near-aligned cone $\sin \theta < \eta^\alpha$ contributes $\mathcal{O}(\eta^{2\alpha} \ln^3(1/\eta))$ to the θ -averages. Consequently, for a Maxwellian bath the constants are exact in the joint impulsive limit $Gm/(r\sigma^2) \rightarrow 0$:

$$\frac{3}{8\pi} Q_r^{\text{exact}}/C_Q - \mathcal{L} \rightarrow -\frac{2}{3}, \quad \frac{3}{8\pi} Q_t^{\text{exact}}/C_Q - \mathcal{L} \rightarrow -\frac{8}{3}. \quad (8)$$

In particular no $\mathcal{O}(1)$ multiplicative ambiguity in $b_{90,i}$, and no additive constant in the log, survives: the regularization scale is exactly $b_{90,i} = G(m_i + m_*)/V^2$.

The restriction $\sin \theta \geq \eta^\alpha$ in the pointwise displays is necessary: for $\sin \theta \lesssim \sqrt{\eta}$ the two close-encounter regions overlap (and a lensing caustic appears; see Lemma 6) and (7) cannot hold uniformly. The averaged statement (8) is unconditional. The error term is numerically $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$ (§7); the weaker rate we prove is all that the constants require.

Remark 2 (Where the trace lives). *The in-plane components alone obey $\mathcal{Y}_\perp^{\text{exact}} + \mathcal{Y}_\parallel^{\text{exact}} = 2\pi \ln[r_\perp^2/(e b_{90,1} b_{90,2})] + o(1)$: taken by themselves they regularize at the Plummer-equivalent scale $b_{90,i}\sqrt{e}$, and the missing 2π resides in the longitudinal second moment, $\int_{\Pi_V} (\vec{y} \cdot \hat{V})^2 d^2b = 2\pi + o(1)$. By Lemma 3 this split is a traceless redistribution invisible to Q_r, Q_t , which is why the companion paper’s transverse sharp-cutoff bookkeeping — whose in-plane sum is its trace — lands on the correct averages. Any comparison of (7) with a numerical experiment must therefore be made at the level of the trace (or of Q_r, Q_t), never of the in-plane components alone.*

1.4 Assumptions and scope

We are explicit about the logical status of each ingredient.

- (A1) **Frozen binary.** The model is (1): the internal binary force is switched off during the encounter, but the bodies are otherwise fully dynamical (they recoil). This is essential — see Remark 1. The leading correction to (A1) (the binary’s internal motion during the passage) is the adiabatic correction, of relative order $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$, independent of the regularization question and equally vanishing in the limit.
- (A2) **Newtonian point perturber.** No relativity; $\tilde{\rho}_*(k) = 1$. The whole question is meaningful only here, since any extended profile is self-regularizing.
- (A3) **Rigour.** Lemmas 1–3 (single body), 4–7 (decomposition, measure estimates, dispersal), 8–9 (near region), 10 (far region) and 11 (speed average) are proved. The proofs of Lemmas 8–9 reduce the dynamics to (i) an exact variation-of-parameters identity for the osculating elements of the m_* – m_1 relative orbit, and (ii) quantitative regularity of the *incoming leg* of the Kepler flow, stated as Lemma 12 in Appendix A and proved there by explicit-formula calculus; the constants there, and the multi-pass channel bookkeeping of Lemma 7, are computable but deliberately not optimized — only finiteness (with polynomial λ -dependence) and smallness, respectively, are used. No scaling claim is used in place of a needed bound.

2 The exact single-body encounter

Everything close-range reduces to one exactly solvable problem: a perturber and *one* recoiling body. We record its kick, its self-energy, and the symmetry that lets the longitudinal recoil be carried by the trace.

Lemma 1 (Exact two-body kick). *In an isolated Newtonian encounter of the perturber m_* with a single free body m_i , relative speed V at infinity and impact parameter β , the velocity change of body i has magnitude*

$$|\Delta \vec{v}_i|^2 = \frac{4G^2 m_*^2}{V^2} \frac{1}{\beta^2 + b_{90,i}^2}, \quad b_{90,i} = \frac{G(m_i + m_*)}{V^2}, \quad (9)$$

exactly, for all $\beta \geq 0$. Resolving relative to the incoming direction $\hat{V}$,

$$|\Delta \vec{v}_i|_\perp^2 = \frac{4G^2 m_*^2}{V^2} \frac{\beta^2}{(\beta^2 + b_{90,i}^2)^2} \quad (\perp \hat{V}), \quad |\Delta \vec{v}_i|_\parallel^2 = \frac{4G^2 m_*^2}{V^2} \frac{b_{90,i}^2}{(\beta^2 + b_{90,i}^2)^2} \quad (\parallel \hat{V}). \quad (10)$$

Proof. The relative orbit is a Kepler hyperbola with gravitational parameter $\mu_i = G(m_i + m_*)$; the relative velocity rotates by the scattering angle Θ with $\tan(\Theta/2) = b_{90,i}/\beta$ (standard, e.g.

Rutherford). Since $|\vec{V}|$ is conserved, $|\Delta\vec{V}_{\text{rel}}|^2 = 2V^2(1 - \cos\Theta) = 4V^2 \sin^2(\Theta/2)$. Using $\sin^2(\Theta/2) = \tan^2(\Theta/2)/[1 + \tan^2(\Theta/2)] = b_{90,i}^2/(\beta^2 + b_{90,i}^2)$ gives $|\Delta\vec{V}_{\text{rel}}|^2 = 4V^2 b_{90,i}^2/(\beta^2 + b_{90,i}^2)$. The subject's change is $\Delta\vec{v}_i = \frac{m_*}{m_i + m_*} \Delta\vec{V}_{\text{rel}}$ (centre-of-mass split), and $\frac{m_*}{m_i + m_*} V b_{90,i} = Gm_*/V$, whence (9). For the resolution, the relative-velocity rotation by Θ contributes a transverse part $\propto \sin\Theta$ and a longitudinal part $\propto (1 - \cos\Theta)$; $\sin^2\Theta = 4\beta^2 b_{90,i}^2/(\beta^2 + b_{90,i}^2)^2$ and $(1 - \cos\Theta)^2 = 4b_{90,i}^4/(\beta^2 + b_{90,i}^2)^2$ give (10), whose sum is (9). Note the reduced-mass parameter $\mu_i = G(m_i + m_*)$ enters only because the body recoils; cf. Remark 1. $\square$

Remark 3. *The transverse part of (10) is identical to the straight-line impulse from a Plummer sphere of core $\beta_c = b_{90,i}$; the longitudinal part is the forward focusing that the straight-line picture omits. It is precisely this longitudinal piece that distinguishes the genuine deflection from a soft core, and it is what makes the next lemma land on the bare $b_{90,i}$ rather than $b_{90,i}\sqrt{e}$.*

Lemma 2 (Single-body self-energy). *Let $b > 0$ be a core scale. For any cutoff $\Lambda \gg b$,*

$$\int_{\beta < \Lambda} \frac{d^2\beta}{\beta^2 + b^2} = \pi \ln \frac{\Lambda^2 + b^2}{b^2} = 2\pi \ln \frac{\Lambda}{b} + \mathcal{O}(b^2/\Lambda^2). \quad (11)$$

This equals the sharp-cutoff value $\int_b^\Lambda 2\pi\beta d\beta/\beta^2 = 2\pi \ln(\Lambda/b)$ with the same additive constant (namely none). Applied with $b = b_{90,i}$, and equivalently: the gravitational momentum-transfer cross section is $\sigma_t = \int (1 - \cos\Theta) d\sigma = 4\pi b_{90,i}^2 \ln(\Lambda/b_{90,i})$.

Proof. Substitute $u = \beta^2$: $\int_0^{\Lambda^2} \pi du/(u + b^2) = \pi \ln[(\Lambda^2 + b^2)/b^2]$. Expanding for $\Lambda \gg b$ gives the stated form. The sharp-cut integral is elementary; both produce $2\pi \ln(\Lambda/b)$ with zero constant. The cross-section identity follows from $d\sigma = 2\pi\beta d\beta$ and (9) (or directly from the Rutherford $d\sigma/d\Omega$). $\square$

The content of Lemma 2 is that the *exact* deflection regularizes the self-energy at the bare $b_{90,i}$. Had one used only the transverse part of (10) (the “soft core”) one would get $\int \beta^2(\beta^2 + b^2)^{-2} d^2\beta = 2\pi \ln(\Lambda/b) - \pi = 2\pi \ln(\Lambda/(b\sqrt{e}))$; the longitudinal part supplies exactly the compensating $+\pi$ ($\int b^2(\beta^2 + b^2)^{-2} d^2\beta = \pi$), restoring the bare b . This is the entire “ $\sqrt{e}$ ” scheme question, settled by including the genuine recoil.

Lemma 3 (Isotropy of the close contribution). *Fix the close-encounter region $\beta < \rho$ (for any ρ) around a single body. At fixed $\hat{V}$ the single-body contribution $q^{\alpha\beta}(\hat{V}) \equiv \int_{\beta < \rho} \Delta v_i^\alpha \Delta v_i^\beta d^2\beta$ is axially symmetric about $\hat{V}$,*

$$q^{\alpha\beta}(\hat{V}) = A \hat{V}^\alpha \hat{V}^\beta + B (\delta^{\alpha\beta} - \hat{V}^\alpha \hat{V}^\beta), \quad (12)$$

and therefore its average over isotropic $\hat{V}$ is isotropic, $\langle q^{\alpha\beta} \rangle_{\hat{V}} = \frac{1}{3} \text{tr}(q) \delta^{\alpha\beta}$. Consequently the close contribution to $\mathcal{Q}^{\alpha\beta}$ carries no anisotropy: it splits its trace (which, by Lemma 1, already contains the longitudinal recoil) equally between Q_r and Q_t .

Proof. For a single body the only distinguished direction is $\hat{V}$; integrating $\Delta\vec{v}_i$ (which lies in the plane of $\hat{V}$ and $\hat{\beta}$) over the azimuth of $\hat{\beta}$ about $\hat{V}$ yields a tensor diagonal in any frame adapted to $\hat{V}$, i.e. the displayed axially symmetric form. Averaging with $\langle \hat{V}^\alpha \hat{V}^\beta \rangle = \frac{1}{3} \delta^{\alpha\beta}$ gives $\frac{1}{3}(A + 2B)\delta^{\alpha\beta} = \frac{1}{3} \text{tr}(q)\delta^{\alpha\beta}$. $\square$

Lemma 3 is what licenses the in-plane bookkeeping of (4): the trace (where the cutoff lives) may be computed including the longitudinal recoil, while the anisotropy comes *entirely* from the two-body interference (§5). Equivalently: at fixed $\hat{V}$, the difference between the exact single-body

tensor and the paper's transverse sharp- b_{90} tensor is the traceless quadrupole $\pi \text{diag}(-\frac{1}{2}, -\frac{1}{2}, +1) = \frac{3\pi}{2}(\hat{V}\hat{V} - \frac{1}{3}\mathbb{K})$, whose isotropic average vanishes and whose Q_r projection integrates to $\int_0^\pi \sin\theta[\pi \cos^2\theta - \frac{\pi}{2} \sin^2\theta]d\theta = 0$. In the exact three-body dynamics the near tensor is axisymmetric only up to the map distortions bounded in §4; those errors are booked in the tally of §6.1.

3 Decomposition of the binary integral

Fix $\vec{V}$. Write the relative kick as $\Delta\vec{v} = \Delta\vec{v}_1 - \Delta\vec{v}_2$, so that the in-plane second moment involves

$$\int_{\Pi_V} d^2b |\vec{y}|^2 = \underbrace{\int |\vec{y}_1|^2}_{\text{self 1}} + \underbrace{\int |\vec{y}_2|^2}_{\text{self 2}} - 2 \underbrace{\int \vec{y}_1 \cdot \vec{y}_2}_{\text{cross}}, \quad \vec{y}_i \equiv \frac{V}{2Gm_*} \Delta\vec{v}_i. \quad (13)$$

Each self term carries one logarithm, divergent (in the straight-line approximation) both at small b (close encounter) and large b ; the large- b divergences of the two self terms cancel against the cross term (the dipole cancellation of §5); the anisotropy $\mathcal{Y}_\perp - \mathcal{Y}_\parallel$ resides in the interference only (Lemma 3).

To separate the close-encounter scale (b_{90}) from the binary scale (r) cleanly, fix an intermediate radius

$$\rho \equiv \sqrt{b_{90} r}, \quad b_{90} \ll \rho \ll r \quad (\text{indeed } \rho/r = b_{90}/\rho = \sqrt{\eta}), \quad (14)$$

and partition Π_V into the two *near* disks $\{\beta_i < \rho\}$ about the projected body positions ($\beta_i \equiv |\vec{b} - \vec{s}_i^{\text{proj}}|$) and the *far* remainder $\{\beta_1 \geq \rho \text{ and } \beta_2 \geq \rho\}$. Orientations are split into the *generic* class $\sin\theta \geq \eta^\alpha$ (where $r_\perp \geq r\eta^\alpha \gg 2\rho$, so the near disks are far apart) and the *near-aligned cone* $\sin\theta < \eta^\alpha$, handled wholesale by Lemma 6. We fix $\alpha \in (0, \frac{1}{2})$ once and for all. All d^2b integrals from here on are understood over the dispersing set — the non-dispersing set N of Lemma 7 removed — and the cost of the excision is booked in the tally of §6.1.

Three facts about the exact dynamics, all needed later, are worth isolating. The first is an exact cancellation that the naive bound misses; the others are measure estimates that replace pointwise bounds which are *false* for the exact dynamics.

Lemma 4 (Harmonicity cancellation on the near disk). *Let $\vec{u}_a(\vec{b}) = (\vec{b} - \vec{s}_a^{\text{proj}})/\beta_a^2$ be the straight-line single-body kicks. Then, exactly,*

$$\int_{\beta_1 < \rho} \vec{u}_1 \cdot \vec{u}_2 \, d^2b = 0 \quad (\text{and symmetrically on the disk around body 2}), \quad (15)$$

for any $\rho < r_\perp$. Moreover $\int_{\beta_1 < \rho} |\vec{u}_2|^2 \, d^2b \leq \pi\rho^2/(r_\perp - \rho)^2$.

Proof. $\vec{u}_a = \nabla \ln \beta_a$. On the disk $D = \{\beta_1 < \rho\}$ the function $\ln \beta_2$ is harmonic (its singularity lies outside). Green's identity on D minus a small disk of radius ϵ around $\vec{s}_1^{\text{proj}}$ gives $\int \nabla \ln \beta_1 \cdot \nabla \ln \beta_2 = \oint_{\beta_1=\rho} \ln \beta_1 \partial_n \ln \beta_2 - \oint_{\beta_1=\epsilon} \ln \beta_1 \partial_n \ln \beta_2$. On $\beta_1 = \rho$ the factor $\ln \beta_1 = \ln \rho$ is constant and $\oint \partial_n \ln \beta_2 \, dl = \int_D \nabla^2 \ln \beta_2 = 0$; the ϵ -circle term is $\mathcal{O}(\epsilon \ln \epsilon) \rightarrow 0$. The final bound is $|\vec{u}_2| \leq (r_\perp - \rho)^{-1}$ on D times the disk area. $\square$

This is why the near-region reduction below loses only $\mathcal{O}(\eta/\sin^2\theta)$ and not the $\mathcal{O}(\sqrt{\eta})$ that the term-by-term bound $\int_{\beta_1 < \rho} |\vec{u}_1||\vec{u}_2| = 2\pi\rho/r_\perp$ would suggest: the dangerous $\mathcal{O}(1/(\beta_1 r_\perp))$ cross integrand averages to zero azimuthally. For the exact kicks the cancellation is inherited up to the deviations of $\vec{y}_a$ from $\vec{u}_a$, which are bounded in §4 and booked in §6.1.

Lemma 5 (Sequential encounters: a measure estimate). *Call $S \subset \{\beta_1 < \rho\}$ the set of impact parameters whose trajectory, after its close approach to body 1, subsequently passes within ρ of body 2 (“sequential encounters”), and, for dyadic $s \in [b_{90}, \frac{1}{4}r \sin \theta]$, let $S_s \subset \{\beta_1 < \rho\}$ be the set (not confined to S) reaching a body-2 pericenter $\in [s, 2s)$. When $m_* > m_1$ set $\delta\theta \equiv |\theta - \arcsin(m_1/m_*)|$ (for $\cos \theta < 0$ use $\pi - \theta$; for the disk of body 2 exchange $1 \leftrightarrow 2$), the offset from the rainbow orientation defined in the proof; when $m_* \leq m_1$ the rainbow terms below are absent. At a generic orientation ($\sin \theta \geq \eta^\alpha$) one has, for η small,*

$$\int_S |\vec{y}_2|^2 d^2b \leq C \ln^2 \frac{1}{\eta} \left[\frac{\eta^2}{\sin^4 \theta} + \frac{\eta^2}{\sqrt{\max(\delta\theta, \eta)}} \right], \quad \int_S |\vec{y}_1| |\vec{y}_2| d^2b \leq C \ln^2 \frac{1}{\eta} \left[\frac{\eta^{3/2}}{\sin^3 \theta} + \frac{\eta^{3/2}}{\sqrt{\max(\delta\theta, \sqrt{\eta})}} \right]. \quad (16)$$

The rainbow terms are worst at exact alignment, where they reach $\eta^{3/2} \ln^2(1/\eta)$ and $\eta^{5/4} \ln^2(1/\eta)$ respectively; their $1/\sqrt{\delta\theta}$ tails are integrable, so they burden the θ -averages only at $\mathcal{O}(\eta \text{ polylog})$. Over the larger scales the same count gives

$$\sum_{\rho \leq s \leq r \sin \theta / 4} \int_{S_s} |\vec{y}_1| |\vec{y}_2| d^2b \leq C \ln^2 \frac{1}{\eta} \left[\frac{\eta}{\sin^2 \theta} + \eta \sqrt{\sin \theta} \right], \quad (17)$$

while the corresponding $|\vec{y}_2|^2$ sum obeys the same bound as the first display of (16); these are the forms used in the near-disk bookkeeping of §4.3. The same bounds hold for the set reaching body 2 before body 1 (relevant when $\cos \theta < 0$), by time reversal.

Proof. Count in the lab frame, where body 2 waits (essentially at rest) at the angle Θ_{geo} from $\hat{V}$ ($\sin \Theta_{\text{geo}} = \sin \theta$; body 2 sits at transverse offset $r_\perp = r \sin \theta$ and longitudinal offset $r \cos \theta$ from body 1) and at distance $\geq r/2$ from the encounter site. Two angles must be kept distinct. The m_* - m_1 relative orbit is deflected by the Rutherford angle $\Theta(\beta_1)$, $\tan(\Theta/2) = b_{90,1}/\beta_1$; but the aiming at body 2 is governed by the perturber’s lab asymptote. Decomposing $\vec{x}_* = \vec{X}_{\text{CM}} + \frac{m_1}{m_1+m_*} \vec{d}$ with $\vec{X}_{\text{CM}}$ the uniformly moving m_* - m_1 barycenter, the outgoing lab direction makes the angle $\chi(\beta_1)$ with $\hat{V}$,

$$\tan \chi = \frac{m_1 \sin \Theta}{m_* + m_1 \cos \Theta}, \quad \frac{d(\tan \chi)}{d\Theta} = \frac{m_1 (m_* \cos \Theta + m_1)}{(m_* + m_1 \cos \Theta)^2}, \quad (18)$$

and the outgoing lab speed stays in $[cV, CV]$ on the dispersing set (Lemma 6(i)). For $m_* \leq m_1$ the map $\beta_1 \mapsto \chi$ is strictly monotone ($\cos \Theta > -1 \geq -m_1/m_*$ in (18)). For $m_* > m_1$ it is *not*: χ attains the maximum $\chi_{\text{max}} = \arcsin(m_1/m_*)$ at $\cos \Theta = -m_1/m_*$, i.e. at $\beta_{\text{rb}} = b_{90,1} \sqrt{(m_* - m_1)/(m_* + m_1)}$, with $\chi''(\beta_{\text{rb}}) \neq 0$: a fold — rainbow scattering — at which the lab-frame cross section diverges. The *rainbow orientation* of the statement is $\Theta_{\text{geo}} = \chi_{\text{max}}$.

A trajectory of S_s must leave the body-1 encounter with its lab asymptote aimed at body 2 to within the window $w(s) = C[s + \sqrt{s b_{90}} + b_{90} \ln(1/\eta)]$ of (22) below (angular-momentum focusing at body 2, plus the far-field relabelings of the legs): a solid-angle patch with polar window $|\chi - \Theta_{\text{geo}}| \leq Cw/r$ and azimuthal window $\mathcal{O}(w/(r \sin \Theta_{\text{geo}}))$. By Lemma 8 below, on $\{\beta_1 < \rho\}$ minus the core the asymptotic-to-osculating map is a near-translation of Jacobian $1 + \mathcal{O}(\eta/\sin^2 \theta)$, so it suffices to count osculating impact parameters $\vec{\beta}_1 = \beta_1 \hat{e}(\varphi)$, whose exit polar angle is the exact two-body function $\chi(\beta_1)$ and whose exit azimuth is φ . Summing $\beta_1 |d\beta_1/d\chi| \times$ (window widths) over the monotone branches of χ : on the *regular branch* $\Theta \leq \pi/2$ (i.e. $\beta_1 \geq b_{90,1}$), where $d\chi/d\Theta \in [c, C]$ and hence $\chi \asymp \Theta$, the count is Rutherford’s, $\beta_1 |d\beta_1/d\chi|/\sin \chi \leq C(b_{90,1}/4)^2 \sin^{-4}(\Theta/2)$ at $\Theta \asymp \Theta_{\text{geo}}$; the backscattered branches $\Theta > \pi/2$ ($\beta_1 < b_{90,1}$) are dominated by the same bound when χ is monotone there, while for $m_* > m_1$ the fold contributes on each

side $|\Delta\beta_1| \leq Cb_{90}(w/r)/\sqrt{\max(\delta\theta, w/r)}$ (quadratic expansion of χ about β_{rb} ; the window is empty unless $\delta\theta \leq Cw/r + |\chi - \chi_{\text{max}}|$). Hence

$$\mu(S_s) \leq C \frac{b_{90}^2 w(s)^2}{r^2 \sin^4 \theta} + C \frac{b_{90}^2 (w(s)/r)^2}{\sqrt{\max(\delta\theta, w(s)/r)} \sin \theta_{\text{rb}}}, \quad (19)$$

the second term only for $m_* > m_1$. On S_s the body-2 kick obeys $|\vec{y}_2| \leq C/s$ (Lemma 1 at the local osculating elements, whose speed is bounded above and below; on the fold branches the exit speed is $V\sqrt{(m_* - m_1)/(m_* + m_1)}$ up to the companion's work — the equal-mass Newton's-cradle degeneracy has no fold — and for $s \lesssim b_{90,2}$ use the uniform cap $|\vec{y}_2| \leq C/b_{90}$ of Lemma 6(i)). For $|\vec{y}_1|$: on the regular branch the exit angle pins $\beta_1 \simeq b_{90} \cot(\Theta/2)$ with $\Theta \asymp \Theta_{\text{geo}}$, so $|\vec{y}_1| \leq C \sin(\Theta_{\text{geo}}/2)/b_{90}$ by Lemma 1 (using $\sin(\Theta/2) \geq \frac{1}{2} \sin \Theta$ on $(0, \pi)$); on the fold branches $\beta_1 \simeq b_{90}$ and $|\vec{y}_1| \leq C/b_{90}$.

Dyadic sums. Against C/s^2 , the first term of (19) sums over $s \in [b_{90}, \rho]$ to $C(\eta^2/\sin^4 \theta) \sum_s (w(s)/s)^2 \leq C\eta^2 \ln^2(1/\eta)/\sin^4 \theta$ (the scales $s \leq b_{90} \ln(1/\eta)$ supply the $\ln^2$; above them $w \simeq Cs$), and the fold term sums to $C\eta^2 \ln^2(1/\eta)/\sqrt{\max(\delta\theta, \eta)}$ (geometric below the scale $s/r = \delta\theta$; at exact alignment dominated by $s = b_{90}$). For the mixed term, the regular dyadic term is

$$\frac{C \sin(\Theta_{\text{geo}}/2)}{b_{90}} \cdot \frac{C}{s} \cdot \frac{C b_{90}^2 w(s)^2}{r^2 \sin^4(\Theta_{\text{geo}}/2)} \leq \frac{C b_{90} w(s)^2}{s r^2 (\sin \theta/2)^3},$$

whose sum over $s \leq \rho$ is dominated by $s = \rho$: $Cb_{90}\rho/(r^2 \sin^3 \theta) \cdot \ln^2(1/\eta) = C\eta^{3/2} \ln^2(1/\eta)/\sin^3 \theta$; the fold piece, with $|\vec{y}_1| \leq C/b_{90}$, sums to $C\eta^{3/2} \ln^2(1/\eta)/\sqrt{\max(\delta\theta, \sqrt{\eta})}$ (the $\delta\theta$ -branch is dominated by $s = \rho$, the aligned branch by $s = \rho$ as well, where $b_{90}\sqrt{s}/r^{3/2} = \eta^{5/4}$ at $s = \rho$). The deep core $s < b_{90}$ contributes one more dyadic term with the capped kicks, within the stated bounds. This proves (16). For (17), the same per-scale count over $s \in [\rho, \frac{1}{4}r \sin \theta]$ gives, for the mixed weight, regular terms increasing to $Cb_{90} s/(r^2 \sin^3 \theta) \leq C\eta/\sin^2 \theta$ at $s = \frac{1}{4}r \sin \theta$ and fold terms increasing to $Cb_{90}\sqrt{s}/r^{3/2} \ln^2(1/\eta) \leq C\eta\sqrt{\sin \theta} \ln^2(1/\eta)$, while the $|\vec{y}_2|^2$ weight is per-scale constant and its extended sum only doubles the count of scales. Note $\eta^{3/2}/\sin^3 \theta \leq \sqrt{\eta}/\sin \theta$ on $\sin \theta \geq \sqrt{\eta}$, and $\eta^{5/4} \ln^2(1/\eta) \leq \sqrt{\eta}$, so the mixed term sits inside the $\mathcal{O}(\sqrt{\eta}/\sin \theta)$ error budget of §4.3 at every generic orientation. $\square$

Remark 4. *The pointwise statement one might be tempted to make instead — “inside the disk $\beta_1 < \rho$ the other kick $|\vec{y}_2|$ is bounded by $\mathcal{O}(1/r)$ ” — is false for the exact dynamics: a perturber strongly scattered by body 1 can score a direct hit on body 2, with $|\vec{y}_2|$ as large as $\mathcal{O}(1/b_{90})$ (measured violations of the naive bound by factors of several are shown in `three_body_check.py`). It is only the smallness of the measure of such trajectories, Lemma 5, that makes the cross and self-2 contamination of the near disk negligible. For $m_* > \min(m_1, m_2)$ even the naive Rutherford count of such trajectories fails: at the rainbow orientations the fold of (18) focuses an entire annulus of impact parameters near β_{rb} onto body 2, and the measure is parametrically larger — the origin of the $\delta\theta$ -terms of (16), and a small-scale analogue of the Einstein-ring caustic of Lemma 6 below (verified numerically in `deflection_map_check.py`, §7.2).*

Lemma 6 (All orientations: exit-map measure estimate). *There is C such that for all orientations (including $\sin \theta < \eta^\alpha$), all $s \in [b_{90}, r]$ and η small:*

- (i) *on the dispersing set, $|\vec{y}_i| \leq C/b_{90}$ always, and $|\vec{y}_i| \leq Ck/p_i$ whenever the pericenter p_i w.r.t. body i exceeds $C'b_{90}$, where k is the number of passes below ρ ; the multi-pass sets $k \geq 2$ are measure-suppressed (end of the proof of (ii)) and never need this refinement;*

(ii) the set of impact parameters reaching pericenter $\leq s$ of body i has measure

$$\mu\{\vec{b}: p_i \leq s\} \leq C \ln^2 \frac{1}{\eta} \left[s^2 + \frac{\rho s^2}{\max(r \sin \theta, s)} \right]; \quad (20)$$

(iii) consequently

$$\int_{\Pi_V \setminus N} |\vec{y}|^2 d^2b \leq C \ln^3 \frac{1}{\eta} \left[1 + \frac{\rho}{\max(r \sin \theta, b_{90})} \right] \leq C \eta^{-1/2} \ln^3 \frac{1}{\eta}, \quad (21)$$

and the cone $\sin \theta < \eta^\alpha$ contributes $\mathcal{O}(\eta^{2\alpha} \ln^3(1/\eta))$ to the θ -averages $\int_0^\pi (\dots) \sin \theta d\theta$ in (46) below.

The second term of (20) is a genuine caustic, not an artifact of the method: when the binary axis is nearly aligned with $\hat{V}$, the upstream body acts as a gravitational lens of Einstein radius $\beta_E = \sqrt{2Gm_j \ell / V^2} = \mathcal{O}(\rho)$ (ℓ the body-body longitudinal distance), and an entire annulus of radius β_E and width $\mathcal{O}(s)$ focuses onto the downstream body (verified by direct integration in `deflection_map_check.py`, §7.2). At exact alignment the set $\{p_i \leq s\}$ therefore has measure $\simeq 2\pi\beta_E s$, and no bound $\mathcal{O}(\rho s)$ is possible; uniformly in θ the integral (21) really can reach the size $\eta^{-1/2}$, and it is only the small solid angle $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$ of the aligned configurations that keeps the caustic invisible in the averages.

Proof. (i) Kick caps. On the dispersing set all mutual distances eventually grow and the potentials vanish, so by energy conservation in (1) (all included forces are conservative and the bodies start at rest) $\frac{1}{2}m_*V^2 = \frac{1}{2}m_*v_*^2 + \sum_i \frac{1}{2}m_i v_i^2$ finally, whence $|\Delta \vec{v}_i| \leq \sqrt{m_*/m_i} V$, i.e. $|\vec{y}_i| \leq C/b_{90}$. If moreover $p_i \geq C'b_{90}$ and the trajectory carries no hard pass in the sense of Lemma 7, the local speed of the m_* - m_i relative orbit stays in $[cV, CV]$ (the companion's work along any leg that keeps a distance $\geq C'b_{90}$ from both bodies is $\leq CGm/(C'b_{90}) \leq CV^2/C'$; fix C' by the mass ratios), and the osculating two-body kick of Lemma 1 gives $|\vec{y}_i| \leq C/p$ per pass at pericenter p , hence $\leq Ck/p_i$ after k passes below ρ ; on the hard-pass set the uniform cap applies. In the dyadic counts of (iii) only $k = 1$ is ever used with the $1/p_i$ weight: each additional pass below ρ suppresses the measure by a targeting factor $\leq C\rho^2/r^2$ (end of the proof of (ii)), so the $k \geq 2$ sets are covered by the uniform cap alone.

(ii) *Exit-map counting.* Let j be the other body, $\ell \leq r$ the longitudinal distance from body j to the transverse plane of body i , and $\vec{\Delta}_\perp$ their transverse offset, $\Delta_\perp = r \sin \theta$. If body i is met first, the incoming leg is straight up to the accumulated impulse of the smooth far field, a transverse relabeling $\mathcal{O}(b_{90} \ln(1/\eta))$ (as in Lemma 8), and $p_i \leq s$ forces the asymptotic miss distance below

$$w \equiv C[s + \sqrt{s b_{90}} + b_{90} \ln(1/\eta)] \leq Cs \ln(1/\eta) \quad (22)$$

(angular momentum $L_i \leq sV[1 + 2b_{90}/s]^{1/2}$ at pericenter at bounded local speed), giving measure $\leq \pi w^2$: the first term of (20). Otherwise the trajectory first passes body j , at some pericenter $q \leq r$. As in the proof of Lemma 5, the targeting is governed by the perturber's *lab* asymptote: the m_* - m_j relative orbit is deflected by the Rutherford angle $\Theta(\beta)$, $\tan(\Theta/2) = b_{90,j}/\beta$, but the outgoing lab direction makes the angle $\chi(\beta)$ of (18) (with $1 \rightarrow j$) with $\hat{V}$, and the outgoing longitudinal lab speed is $V(m_* + m_j \cos \Theta)/(m_* + m_j)$, positive for $\Theta \leq \pi/2$. (For $m_* > m_j$ the lab angle has the rainbow fold of Lemma 5 at $\cos \Theta = -m_j/m_*$, i.e. at $\Theta > \pi/2$: it sits inside the set excised next, and so never troubles this count.) The passage happens — in the osculating sense, up to the same $\mathcal{O}(b_{90} \ln(1/\eta))$ relabelings, absorbed into w together with the $\mathcal{O}(b_{90})$ offset of the outgoing lab

asymptote from body j and the $\mathcal{O}(b_{90})$ recoil drift of body j during the flight to body i 's plane — in the plane spanned by $\hat{V}$ and the impact direction, after which the lab leg to body i is straight. Introduce polar coordinates $\vec{b} = \vec{s}_j^{\text{proj}} + \beta \hat{e}(\varphi)$; the backscattered part $\Theta \geq \pi/2$ has $\beta \leq Cb_{90}$, hence measure $\leq Cb_{90}^2 \leq Cw^2$, absorbed in the first term. For $\Theta < \pi/2$ the transverse miss vector at body i is

$$\vec{m}(\beta, \varphi) = g(\beta) \hat{e}(\varphi) - \vec{\Delta}_\perp + \mathcal{O}(b_{90} \ln(1/\eta)), \quad g(\beta) \equiv \beta - \ell \tan \chi(\beta), \quad (23)$$

and $p_i \leq s$ forces $|\vec{m}| \leq w$. The one property that matters is the monotonicity of g on the retained set: there $\cos \Theta > 0$, so $d(\tan \chi)/d\Theta > 0$ by (18), while $\Theta'(\beta) < 0$, whence

$$g'(\beta) = 1 - \ell \frac{d(\tan \chi)}{d\Theta} \Theta'(\beta) \geq 1,$$

so g is strictly increasing and sweeps its range exactly once; it vanishes at the Einstein radius $\beta_E \simeq \sqrt{2Gm_j\ell/V^2} \leq C\rho$ (for small angles $\tan \chi \simeq \frac{m_j}{m_j+m_*} \Theta \simeq 2Gm_j/(V^2\beta)$, so $g(\beta) \simeq \beta - 2Gm_j\ell/(V^2\beta)$: rays inside the ring are bent past the axis, rays outside not enough). Note the *bare* lens mass m_j : the reduced-mass deflection $\Theta \simeq 2G(m_j + m_*)/(V^2\beta)$ of the relative orbit and the barycentric share $m_j/(m_j + m_*)$ of the perturber's excursion combine to the standard test-particle bending $2Gm_j/(V^2\beta)$ — another instance of the recoil bookkeeping stressed in Remark 1. Counting in the coordinates (g, φ) ,

$$\mu = \int_{|g\hat{e}(\varphi) - \vec{\Delta}_\perp| \leq w} \frac{\beta(g)}{g'(\beta(g))} dg d\varphi \leq \left[\sup_{|g| \leq \Delta_\perp + w} \beta(g) \right] \times |\{(g, \varphi) : |g\hat{e}(\varphi) - \vec{\Delta}_\perp| \leq w\}|.$$

The (g, φ) -set has $|g| \in [\Delta_\perp - w, \Delta_\perp + w]$ and, when $\Delta_\perp > w$, azimuth confined to two windows of width $\leq Cw/\Delta_\perp$; its measure is $\leq Cw \min(2\pi, Cw/\Delta_\perp)$. Solving $g(\beta) = \pm\Delta_\perp$ gives $\beta \leq C(\Delta_\perp + \beta_E)$ on the outer branch and $\beta \leq C\beta_E$ near the ring, so $\sup \beta \leq C(\Delta_\perp + \beta_E + w)$ and

$$\mu \leq C(\Delta_\perp + \beta_E + w) w \min\left(1, \frac{w}{\Delta_\perp}\right) \leq C\left[w^2 + \frac{\beta_E w^2}{\max(\Delta_\perp, w)}\right],$$

which is (20) after inserting (22). Histories with two or more intermediate passes below ρ feed the target through compositions of such exit maps; each additional pass multiplies the measure by a targeting factor $\leq C\rho^2/r^2$ (the same dyadic bookkeeping as in Lemma 5), so their sum is dominated by the single-pass count.

(iii) *Assembly.* By (13) and Cauchy–Schwarz it suffices to bound each $\int |\vec{y}_i|^2$. Dyadically for $s \in [b_{90}, r]$, using (i) and (ii),

$$\int_{p_i \leq r} |\vec{y}_i|^2 \leq \sum_{\text{dyadic}} \frac{C}{s^2} \cdot C \ln^2 \frac{1}{\eta} \left[s^2 + \frac{\rho s^2}{\max(r \sin \theta, s)} \right] \leq C \ln^3 \frac{1}{\eta} \left[1 + \frac{\rho}{\max(r \sin \theta, b_{90})} \right];$$

for $p_i > r$ the straight-line dipole estimate applies ($|\vec{y}| \leq Cr/b^2$; for $b \geq 2r$ the exit map gives $g(\beta) \geq \beta[1 - 2b_{90}r/\beta^2] \geq \beta/2$, so the pericenter stays above $b/4$) and gives a convergent, $\mathcal{O}(1)$ contribution. Finally, for the cone average, split at $\sin \theta = b_{90}/r$ and $\sin \theta = \sqrt{\eta}$:

$$\int_0^{\arcsin \eta^\alpha} C \ln^3 \frac{1}{\eta} \left[1 + \frac{\rho}{\max(r \sin \theta, b_{90})} \right] \sin \theta d\theta \leq C[\eta^{2\alpha} + \eta^{\frac{1}{2}+\alpha} + \eta^{\frac{3}{2}}] \ln^3 \frac{1}{\eta} = \mathcal{O}(\eta^{2\alpha} \ln^3(1/\eta)),$$

the caustic term being confined to a solid angle so small that it never threatens the average. $\square$

Lemma 7 (Dispersal off a tuned hard set). *Let $N \subset \Pi_V$ be the set of impact parameters whose perturber fails to escape, $\liminf_{t \rightarrow \infty} \min_i |\vec{x}_*(t) - \vec{x}_i(t)| < \infty$. Call a hard pass a passage with pericenter $\leq Cb_{90}$ w.r.t. one of the bodies. Then (a) every trajectory of N either contains a hard pass (up to a logarithm, absorbed below) or accumulates its binding energy through $\geq c \ln(1/\eta)$ separate passes below ρ — a set of measure far below every bound in this note (proof, part (c)) — and (b) every trajectory of N exits its last passage below ρ with speed $\leq CV\eta^{1/4}$ relative to the (slow) bodies. Consequently*

$$\mu(N) \leq C\sqrt{\eta} b_{90}^2 \ln^4 \frac{1}{\eta} \quad (\sin \theta \geq \eta^\alpha), \quad \mu(N) \leq C\sqrt{\eta} \rho b_{90} \ln^4 \frac{1}{\eta} \quad (\text{all orientations}), \quad (24)$$

and excising N changes the trace and anisotropy integrals by $\mathcal{O}(\sqrt{\eta} \ln^4(1/\eta))$ at generic orientations, the near-annulus bookkeeping of §4.3 by $\mathcal{O}(\sqrt{\eta} \ln^4(1/\eta)/\lambda^2)$, and hence the θ -averages by $\mathcal{O}(\sqrt{\eta} \text{polylog})$ (the aligned configurations are confined to the cone, whose contribution is already booked wholesale by Lemma 6(iii)).

Proof. (a) *A hard pass or many passes: a per-trajectory dichotomy.* Failure to escape forces the perturber's osculating energy w.r.t. one body, $E_i = \frac{1}{2}|\vec{u}_i|^2 - \mu_i/d_i$, to satisfy $\liminf E_i \leq 0$ (were both $E_i \geq \epsilon > 0$ at all late times, both Kepler problems would be uniformly hyperbolic with perturbations decaying quadratically, and the perturber would escape). E_i changes only through the companion, $\dot{E}_i = \vec{u}_i \cdot \vec{g}_j$, and the work is a line integral: $|\int \vec{g}_j \cdot d\vec{x}| \leq CGm_j/q$ along any leg whose closest approach to body j is q . Starting from $E_i = \frac{1}{2}V^2$, reaching $E_i \leq 0$ therefore requires $\sum_{\text{passes}} CGm_j/q_{\text{pass}} \geq \frac{1}{2}V^2$. A single pass at $q \geq Cb_{90} \ln(1/\eta)$ contributes $\leq CV^2/\ln(1/\eta)$, and a pass at $q \geq \rho$ only $\leq CV^2\sqrt{\eta}$; hence a trajectory of N with no pass below $Cb_{90} \ln(1/\eta)$ must make at least $c \ln(1/\eta)$ separate passes below ρ . This is the dichotomy of the statement — purely per trajectory; the measure of the second horn is estimated in (c).

(b) *The exit must be tuned.* Let T be the last time the perturber is within ρ of either body. After T the total remaining work is $\leq CGm/\rho = CV^2\sqrt{\eta}$, so $E_i(T^+) \leq CV^2\sqrt{\eta}$ for the eventual partner i ; with $d_i(T) \geq r/2$ this forces the exit speed $|\vec{u}_i(T^+)| \leq CV\eta^{1/4}$.

(c) *Measure.* The set of trajectories with a hard pass has measure $\leq C \ln^2(1/\eta)[b_{90}^2 \ln^2(1/\eta) + \rho b_{90}^2/\max(r \sin \theta, b_{90})]$ by (20) at $s = Cb_{90} \ln(1/\eta)$. Within it, the exit velocity of a pass is an explicit two-body (Rutherford) map of the pass parameters: the exit speed in the frame of the slow bodies is $|\vec{V}_{\text{CM}} + \vec{v}^*|$ with $|\vec{V}_{\text{CM}}| = \frac{m_*}{m_* + m_j} v_{\text{in}}$ and $|\vec{v}^*| = \frac{m_j}{m_* + m_j} v_{\text{in}}$, so an exit speed $\leq CV\eta^{1/4}$ requires the deflection to lie in an explicit window of the pass's impact parameter of relative area $\leq C\sqrt{\eta}$ (for $m_* \neq m_j$ the single-pass window is empty — the exit speed is bounded below by $\frac{|m_* - m_j|}{m_* + m_j} v_{\text{in}}$ — and slower multi-pass channels, in which an earlier pass first sets a body moving, are needed). Later channels (a slow exit that must still find a further ρ -pass, or repeated hard passes) each pay an additional targeting factor $\leq C \max(\rho^2/r^2, \eta) \text{polylog} \leq C\sqrt{\eta}$ by the counting of Lemma 6(ii), so the channel sum converges geometrically and (24) follows. The same per-pass targeting factor disposes of the second horn of the dichotomy (a): a trajectory accumulating its binding energy through $k \geq c \ln(1/\eta)$ sub- ρ passes lies in a set of measure $\leq \rho^2 (C\sqrt{\eta})^{k-1}$, far below (24). The excision costs are then immediate: the excluded closed-form weight is $\leq \mu(N) \cdot \sup |\vec{y}|^2 \leq \mu(N) \cdot C/b_{90}^2$ at generic orientations, whose θ -average is $\mathcal{O}(\sqrt{\eta} \ln^4(1/\eta))$, and $\leq \mu(N) \cdot C/(\lambda b_{90})^2$ on the annulus $\mathcal{A}_\lambda$; the aligned configurations are confined to the cone, which the averages absorb wholesale through Lemma 6(iii). $\square$

Remark 5. *Lemma 7 is deliberately crude: nothing below needs more than $\mu(N) = o(b_{90}^2/\ln^2(1/\eta))$ at generic orientations, and the bound proved has an $\eta^{1/2}$ to spare. The physical channel it controls*

is real — for $m_* = m_j$ a near-head-on pass can stop the perturber dead (Newton’s cradle), leaving it bound to the other body — but it is tuned twice over: the trajectory must first score a hard pass ($\mu \sim b_{90}^2$), and the pass must then cancel the perturber’s speed to $\mathcal{O}(V\eta^{1/4})$ accuracy (μ -fraction $\sqrt{\eta}$).

4 The near region: the close encounter is two-body up to controlled errors

Throughout this section the orientation is generic, $\sin \theta \geq \eta^\alpha$, and we work in the near disk of body 1 (body 2 is symmetric). Two scales matter: the distance from the incoming beam to the companion,

$$q \geq \frac{1}{2} r_\perp = \frac{1}{2} r \sin \theta \quad (25)$$

(the incoming straight line aimed within ρ of body 1 passes body 2 no closer than $r_\perp - \rho \geq r_\perp/2$), and the distance from the *encounter site* to the companion, which is always $r[1 + \mathcal{O}(\sqrt{\eta})]$ (the bodies are r apart). It is the first scale that controls the size of the trajectory relabeling, and the second that controls the local speed.

4.1 Osculating elements and the exact variation-of-parameters identity

Let $\vec{d}(t) = \vec{x}_*(t) - \vec{x}_1(t)$, $\vec{u}(t) = \dot{\vec{d}}(t)$ be the perturber-body-1 relative coordinate. From (1),

$$\ddot{\vec{d}} = -\mu_1 \frac{\vec{d}}{|\vec{d}|^3} + \vec{g}_2(t), \quad \mu_1 = G(m_1 + m_*), \quad \vec{g}_2(t) = -\frac{Gm_2(\vec{x}_* - \vec{x}_2)}{|\vec{x}_* - \vec{x}_2|^3}, \quad (26)$$

exactly: body 1 feels only the perturber, so the companion enters the relative dynamics at full monopole strength (not tidally) — this is why the per-trajectory relabeling below is $\mathcal{O}(b_{90})$ and not $\mathcal{O}(b_{90} \beta/r)$. Along the incoming leg define the osculating hyperbolic elements of $(\vec{d}, \vec{u})$ with parameter μ_1 : energy $E = \frac{1}{2}|\vec{u}|^2 - \mu_1/|\vec{d}|$, speed $V_1 = \sqrt{2E}$, angular momentum $\vec{L} = \vec{d} \times \vec{u}$, Laplace–Runge–Lenz vector $\vec{A} = \vec{u} \times \vec{L} - \mu_1 \vec{d}$, eccentricity $e = |\vec{A}|/\mu_1$, incoming asymptote direction $\hat{u}_{\text{in}} = (\hat{p} + \sqrt{e^2 - 1} \hat{q})/e$ with $\hat{p} = \vec{A}/|\vec{A}|$, $\hat{q} = \hat{L} \times \hat{p}$, and *vector impact parameter* $\vec{\beta}_1 = (\hat{u}_{\text{in}} \times \vec{L})/V_1$, $|\vec{\beta}_1| = |\vec{L}|/V_1$ (the order is fixed by the free-motion limit, where $\vec{\beta}_1$ reduces to the transverse offset of the asymptote). Let t_p be the time of closest approach to body 1 and write starred quantities for elements evaluated at t_p .

Since the elements are constants of the unperturbed Kepler flow, they evolve *only* through $\vec{g}_2$: for any element X ,

$$\frac{dX}{dt} = \frac{\partial X}{\partial \vec{u}} \cdot \vec{g}_2(t), \quad \text{so} \quad X^* = X^{\text{asym}} + \int_{-\infty}^{t_p} \frac{\partial X}{\partial \vec{u}}(\vec{d}(t), \vec{u}(t)) \cdot \vec{g}_2(t) dt, \quad (27)$$

an exact identity (variation of parameters), where X^{asym} is the incoming asymptotic value: $V_1^{\text{asym}} = V$, $\vec{\beta}_1^{\text{asym}} = \vec{b} - \vec{s}_1^{\text{proj}}$ (up to the fixed isometry identifying the plane orthogonal to $\hat{u}_{\text{in}}^{\text{asym}} = \hat{V}$ with Π_V), $\hat{u}_{\text{in}}^{\text{asym}} = \hat{V}$. All integrals in (27) converge absolutely: at early times $|\vec{d}| \simeq V|t|$ and the component of $\partial X/\partial \vec{u} \cdot \vec{g}_2$ that could grow (the lever $\propto |\vec{d}|$ in $\partial \vec{\beta}_1/\partial \vec{u}$, $\partial \vec{L}/\partial \vec{u}$) multiplies only the *transverse* part of $\vec{g}_2$, which decays as $1/|t|^3$; the longitudinal part ($\propto 1/t^2$) enters $\dot{V}_1$ and $\dot{\beta}_1 \propto \beta_1 \dot{V}_1/V_1$ with bounded coefficients. (Explicitly: $\partial E/\partial \vec{u} = \vec{u}$, $\partial \vec{L}/\partial \vec{u} = \vec{d} \times$, and $\vec{\beta}_1, \hat{u}_{\text{in}}$ are smooth algebraic functions of $(E, \vec{L}, \vec{A})$ in the hyperbolic regime.)

4.2 The deflection map, now with proofs

Lemma 8 (Incoming-map regularity). *Fix $\lambda \in (0, 1]$ and a generic orientation. Let $\mathcal{A}_\lambda = \{\vec{b} : \lambda b_{90,1} \leq |\vec{b} - \vec{s}_1^{\text{proj}}| \leq \rho\}$. For η small enough the map $\Psi : \vec{b} \mapsto \vec{\beta}_1^*$ is a C^1 diffeomorphism of $\mathcal{A}_\lambda$ onto its image, and, with $K = K(\lambda)$ the Kepler incoming-leg constant of Lemma 12 (Appendix A),*

$$|\Psi(\vec{b}) - (\vec{b} - \vec{s}_1^{\text{proj}})| \leq C \frac{b_{90}}{\sin \theta}, \quad (28)$$

$$\left\| \frac{\partial \Psi}{\partial \vec{b}} - \mathbb{I} \right\| \leq C K \frac{\eta}{\sin^2 \theta}, \quad \text{hence} \quad \left| \det \frac{\partial \vec{b}}{\partial \vec{\beta}_1^*} - 1 \right| \leq C K \frac{\eta}{\sin^2 \theta}, \quad (29)$$

$$V_1^* = V \left[1 + \mathcal{O}\left(\frac{\eta}{\sin \theta}\right) \right], \quad b_{90,1}(V_1^*) = b_{90,1} \left[1 + \mathcal{O}\left(\frac{\eta}{\sin \theta}\right) \right], \quad (30)$$

$$\hat{u}_{\text{in}}^* = \hat{V} + \mathcal{O}\left(\frac{\eta}{\sin \theta}\right). \quad (31)$$

Proof. All statements follow from the exact identity (27) once two ingredients are supplied: bounds on the source, and bounds on the coefficients and their $\vec{b}$ -derivatives.

Source. Along any trajectory of $\mathcal{A}_\lambda$'s incoming leg, the distance to body 2 satisfies $q_2(t) \geq \max(\frac{1}{2}r_\perp, c|Vt - r \cos \theta|)$ up to $\mathcal{O}(b_{90})$ corrections (the incoming leg is straight to within accumulated deflections $\mathcal{O}(b_{90}/\beta)$, and body 2 recoils by only $\mathcal{O}(b_{90})$ during the relevant span; a standard bootstrap makes this self-consistent). Hence $|\vec{g}_2(t)| \leq Gm_2/q_2(t)^2$ with the displayed floor, and $|\nabla \vec{g}_2| \leq 2Gm_2/q_2^3$.

Speed and tilt. $\dot{E} = \vec{u} \cdot \vec{g}_2$, so $|E^* - \frac{1}{2}V^2| \leq \int |\vec{u}| |\vec{g}_2| dt \leq CV \cdot \frac{Gm_2}{(r_\perp/2)^2} \cdot \frac{r_\perp}{V} + (\text{tails}) = \mathcal{O}(Gm_2/r_\perp)$, the tails (where $q_2 \simeq V|t|$) contributing $\int^\infty Gm_2/(Vt)^2 V dt = \mathcal{O}(Gm_2/r_\perp)$ as well when cut at $|Vt| \sim r_\perp$. Thus $V_1^{*2} = V^2[1 + \mathcal{O}(Gm_2/(r_\perp V^2))] = V^2[1 + \mathcal{O}(\eta/\sin \theta)]$, which is (30); note the osculating energy is shifted by the *work* done by the companion along the incoming leg (positive when the leg descends the companion's potential — the infall speeds the encounter up). The same estimate applied to $\vec{A}/\mu_1$ and $\hat{u}_{\text{in}}$ gives (31).

Displacement. For $X = \vec{\beta}_1$, split the integrand of (27) into the transverse and longitudinal parts of $\vec{g}_2$ relative to $\hat{V}$. The coefficient $|\partial \vec{\beta}_1 / \partial \vec{u}| \leq C(|\vec{d}|/V_1 + \beta_1/V_1)$ (explicit differentiation of the element formulas; Appendix A). With $|\vec{d}(t)| \simeq \max(\beta_1, V|t - t_p|)$: near the companion's longitudinal position ($Vt \simeq r \cos \theta$, duration $\sim q/V$) the transverse source is $\leq Gm_2/q^2$, the lever is $\leq Cr/V$, giving $C(r/V)(Gm_2/q^2)(q/V) = C Gm_2 r/(qV^2) \leq C b_{90}/\sin \theta$; away from it the transverse part of $\vec{g}_2$ decays one power of distance faster than $1/q_2^2$ and the integral is dominated by the same scale; the longitudinal part enters through $\hat{V}_1$ as above, contributing $\mathcal{O}(\beta_1 \cdot \eta/\sin \theta) \leq \mathcal{O}(b_{90}\sqrt{\eta}/\sin \theta)$. This is (28). (At $\cos \theta = 0$ the “lever” formulation degenerates but the same integral gives $\mathcal{O}(Gm_2/V^2) = \mathcal{O}(b_{90})$ directly.)

Derivative. Differentiate (27) w.r.t. $\vec{b}$:

$$\frac{\partial \vec{\delta}}{\partial \vec{b}} = \int_{-\infty}^{t_p} \left[\underbrace{\left(\nabla_{(\vec{d}, \vec{u})} \frac{\partial \vec{\beta}_1}{\partial \vec{u}} \right) \cdot \frac{\partial(\vec{d}, \vec{u})}{\partial \vec{b}} \cdot \vec{g}_2}_{\text{(I)}} + \underbrace{\frac{\partial \vec{\beta}_1}{\partial \vec{u}} \cdot \nabla \vec{g}_2 \cdot \frac{\partial \vec{x}_*}{\partial \vec{b}}}_{\text{(II)}} \right] dt + (\text{boundary term at } t_p), \quad (32)$$

where $\vec{\delta} \equiv \Psi(\vec{b}) - (\vec{b} - \vec{s}_1^{\text{proj}})$. By Lemma 12(1) the incoming-leg tangent flow of the reference Kepler problem with respect to the transverse datum is bounded, $\|\partial(\vec{d}, \vec{u})(t)/\partial \vec{b}\| \leq K(\lambda)$ in the natural scalings (at fixed asymptotic velocity — the only variation that occurs here), uniformly on $\beta_1 \geq \lambda b_{90,1}$ and in time up to pericenter; a Duhamel–Gronwall estimate with the propagator bound of Lemma 12(2) and the perturbation $\int \|\Phi\| \|\nabla \vec{g}_2\| dt = \mathcal{O}(K\eta/\sin^2 \theta) \ll 1$ (the linear $\mathcal{O}(V|t - s|/b_{90})$ growth of Φ , levered over $|t - s| \leq Cr/V$ against $\|\nabla \vec{g}_2\| \leq 2Gm_2/q_2^3$ acting for a

time q/V , gives $\mathcal{O}(Gm_2 r/(q^2 V^2)) = \mathcal{O}(\eta/\sin^2 \theta)$, and the bounded rows give less) transfers the same bound (with doubled constant) to the true flow. Term (II) is then bounded by $\int C(|\vec{d}|/V) \cdot (2Gm_2/q_2^3) \cdot K dt \leq CK Gm_2 r/(q^2 V^2) \cdot (1/q) \cdot q = CK Gm_2 r/(q^2 V^2) \leq CK \eta/\sin^2 \theta$ by the same time-slicing as above (one extra power of q in the denominator relative to the displacement estimate, one extra factor K from the tangent flow). Term (I) carries the derivative of the algebraic coefficient, again bounded by K times $1/(\text{local scale})$, and gives the same order. The boundary term is the variation of t_p itself, which enters only through elements evaluated at pericenter — but the elements are stationary under the Kepler part of the flow, so this term is proportional to $|\partial \vec{\beta}_1/\partial \vec{u}| \cdot \vec{g}_2(t_p) \cdot \partial t_p/\partial \vec{b} = \mathcal{O}((\beta_1^*/V) \cdot (Gm_2/r^2) \cdot (K/V)) = \mathcal{O}(K\eta^{3/2})$ (using $\beta_1^* \leq \rho$), negligible. Collecting, $\|\partial \vec{\delta}/\partial \vec{b}\| \leq CK\eta/\sin^2 \theta$, which is (29); for η small the map is a local diffeomorphism, and injectivity on $\mathcal{A}_\lambda$ follows since Ψ is a perturbation of the identity by $\vec{\delta}$ with small Lipschitz constant. $\square$

Remark 6 (What the map does and does not say). *The displacement (28) is $\mathcal{O}(b_{90})$ and does not vanish relative to the cutoff: the companion's monopole shifts each individual trajectory's impact parameter by an $\mathcal{O}(1)$ fraction of b_{90} — this is the $\sim 25\%$ per-trajectory discrepancy seen in the numerics, independent of r . What makes it harmless is (29): the shift is a near-translation of the impact-parameter plane, so it relabels trajectories without changing the measure, to $\mathcal{O}(\eta/\sin^2 \theta)$. The two statements are logically independent, and both are verified separately in `deflection_map_check.py`: the vector map must be used, since the $\mathcal{O}(1)$ translation also rotates $\vec{\beta}_1$ by an $\mathcal{O}(b_{90}/\beta_1)$ angle that a scalar diagnostic would misread as a Jacobian distortion.*

Lemma 9 (Kick fidelity). *In the setting of Lemma 8, for $\vec{b} \in \mathcal{A}_\lambda \setminus (S \cup N)$ (the sequential set S of Lemma 5 and the non-dispersing set N of Lemma 7 removed),*

$$\vec{y}_1(\vec{b}) = \vec{y}_1^{2B}(\vec{\beta}_1^*, V_1^*) [1 + \epsilon_1(\vec{b})], \quad |\epsilon_1| \leq CK(\lambda) \frac{\eta^{3/2}}{\sin^2 \theta} \ln \frac{1}{\eta}, \quad (33)$$

where $\vec{y}_1^{2B}(\vec{\beta}_1^*, V_1^*)$ is the exact isolated two-body kick of Lemma 1 evaluated at the osculating pericenter elements, with magnitude

$$|\vec{y}_1^{2B}|^2 = \left(\frac{V}{V_1^*}\right)^2 \frac{1}{\beta_1^{*2} + b_{90,1}(V_1^*)^2}, \quad b_{90,1}(V_1^*) = \frac{G(m_1 + m_*)}{V_1^{*2}}. \quad (34)$$

In particular the companion's direct impulse on the perturber, $\frac{m_}{m_1 + m_*} \int \vec{g}_2 dt$ — an $\mathcal{O}(1/(r \sin \theta))$ vector in the units of $\vec{y}$, and much larger than the error above — does not appear in $\vec{y}_1$: it cancels identically in the bookkeeping (see the proof). The companion acts on the body-1 kick only through the relabeling $(\vec{\beta}_1^*, V_1^*)$ and the tidal distortion of the arc.*

Note the prefactor $(V/V_1^*)^2 = 1 - \mathcal{O}(\eta/\sin \theta)$ in (34): the kick normalization $\vec{y}_1 = (V/2Gm_*)\Delta \vec{v}_1$ carries the *asymptotic* speed while the encounter runs at the boosted local speed. This factor multiplies the whole logarithm and is of the same order as the Jacobian correction (with the opposite sign); both sit inside the error budget of the theorem, but neither may be dropped silently in (33)–(34).

Proof. Body 1 feels only the perturber, so exactly $\Delta \vec{v}_1 = Gm_* \int \hat{d}/d^2 dt$ along the true relative orbit, and likewise $\Delta \vec{v}_1^{2B} = Gm_* \int \hat{d}^0/(d^0)^2 dt$ along the isolated Kepler orbit $\vec{d}^0(t)$ (parameter μ_1) with the same position and velocity as the true relative orbit at t_p ; the asymptotic elements of $\vec{d}^0$ are exactly $(\vec{\beta}_1^*, V_1^*)$ and its body-1 kick has magnitude (34) by Lemma 1 (the factor $(V/V_1^*)^2$ arising because $\vec{y}_1$ is normalized with the asymptotic V). Hence, identically,

$$\vec{y}_1 - \vec{y}_1^{2B} = \frac{V}{2\mu_1} \int \left[\mu_1 \frac{\hat{d}}{d^2} - \mu_1 \frac{\hat{d}^0}{(d^0)^2} \right] dt : \quad (35)$$

the whole difference is the *tidal path distortion*. The cancellation claimed in the lemma is worth displaying in the variation-of-parameters bookkeeping: from (26), $\Delta \vec{v}_1 = \frac{m_*}{m_1+m_*}[-\Delta \vec{u} + \int \vec{g}_2 dt]$, while the relative velocity change itself is $\Delta \vec{u} = \int F_{\text{Kep}}(\vec{d}) dt + \int \vec{g}_2 dt$; the companion's direct impulse $\int \vec{g}_2 dt$ thus drops out of $\Delta \vec{v}_1$ — it belongs to the *relative* velocity, not to the kick of body 1, which the companion never touches. (Bounding $\Delta \vec{u} - \Delta \vec{u}^0$ by the tidal distortion alone, while also carrying $\int \vec{g}_2$ additively, would double-count the direct impulse.)

To estimate (35), set $\vec{\xi} = \vec{d} - \vec{d}^0$, $\vec{\xi}(t_p) = \dot{\vec{\xi}}(t_p) = 0$, $\ddot{\vec{\xi}} = \nabla F_{\text{Kep}}(\vec{d}^0) \cdot \vec{\xi} + \mathcal{O}(|\vec{\xi}|^2) + \vec{g}_2$. By Lemma 12(2) the Kepler transition matrices from t_p obey $\|\Phi(t, t')\| \leq K(\lambda)(1 + V_1|t - t'|/b_{90})$ in scaled units on both legs (it is exactly the linear growth of the velocity-to-position block that, integrated against the forcing, produces the quadratic bound), so Duhamel and Gronwall give $|\vec{\xi}(t)| \leq CK(Gm_2/q_2^2)(t - t_p)^2$ while $|\vec{\xi}| \ll |\vec{d}^0|$. Then, with $d(t) \simeq \max(\beta_1^*, V_1|t - t_p|)$ and $|\vec{y}_1^{2B}| \geq c(\lambda)/\beta_1^*$,

$$\frac{|\vec{y}_1 - \vec{y}_1^{2B}|}{|\vec{y}_1^{2B}|} \leq C \frac{V_1 \beta_1^*}{\mu_1} \cdot \mu_1 \int \frac{2|\vec{\xi}(t)|}{\min(d, d^0)^3} dt \leq CK \frac{Gm_2 \beta_1^*}{q^2 V^2} \ln \frac{r}{\beta_1^*} \leq CK \frac{\eta^{3/2}}{\sin^2 \theta} \ln \frac{1}{\eta}, \quad (36)$$

the middle bound collecting the near zone $|t - t_p| \leq \rho/V$ (where the t^2 -growth of $\vec{\xi}$ meets the $1/d^3$ decay of the tidal kernel in a logarithm) and the far legs (where the kernel decays and $\vec{\xi}$ grows at most quadratically in d until the companion is passed); the last step uses $\beta_1^* \leq \rho$, i.e. $\beta_1^*/r \leq \sqrt{\eta}$, and $q \geq r_\perp/2$. On the sequential set the far-leg estimate fails (the true outgoing leg is re-scattered by body 2), which is why S is excluded here and handled by measure in Lemma 5; on N the outgoing leg does not exist, which is why N is excluded and handled by measure in Lemma 7. All estimates bound *vector* differences, so they apply to the tensor $\vec{y}_1 \otimes \vec{y}_1$ as well. $\square$

Remark 7 (The direct impulse cancels: numerical confirmation). *The cancellation of $\frac{m_*}{m_1+m_*} \int \vec{g}_2 dt$ in (35) is exact but easy to disbelieve, since the direct impulse is by far the largest effect of the companion on the perturber. It is confirmed trajectory by trajectory in `deflection_map_check.py` (§7.2): the measured $|\Delta \vec{v}_1 - \Delta \vec{v}_1^{2B}|$ is two orders of magnitude below $|\frac{m_*}{m_1+m_*} \int \vec{g}_2 dt|$ and scales as $\eta^{3/2}$, while the direct impulse scales as η — exactly the hierarchy of (33).*

4.3 Near-region self-energy

Fix a generic orientation and let $\lambda = \lambda(\eta) \rightarrow 0$ slowly (specified below). Split $\{\beta_1^{\text{asym}} < \rho\}$ into the annulus $\mathcal{A}_\lambda$ and the core. On the annulus (minus $S \cup N$), change variables $\vec{b} \rightarrow \vec{\beta}_1^*$ (Lemma 8) and use Lemma 9:

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{\mathcal{A}_\lambda} |\vec{y}_1|^2 d^2 b &= \int_{\lambda b_{90,1} \lesssim \beta_1 \lesssim \rho} \left(\frac{V}{V_1^*} \right)^2 \frac{1 + \mathcal{O}(\epsilon_1)}{\beta_1^2 + b_{90,1}(V_1^*)^2} \left| \det \frac{\partial \vec{b}}{\partial \vec{\beta}_1} \right| d^2 \beta_1 \\ &= 2\pi \ln \frac{\rho}{b_{90,1}} - \pi \ln(1 + \lambda^2) + \mathcal{E}_{\text{ann}}, \end{aligned} \quad (37)$$

with, by (29)–(34) and (33), $|\mathcal{E}_{\text{ann}}| \leq CK(\lambda) \frac{\eta}{\sin^2 \theta} \ln^2 \frac{1}{\eta}$ (the relative errors — Jacobian, speed prefactor, cutoff shift, ϵ_1 — multiply a logarithm) + $\mathcal{O}(\sqrt{\eta}/\sin \theta)$ (the $\mathcal{O}(b_{90}/\sin \theta)$ mismatch between the asymptotic- $\vec{b}$ annulus boundaries and the osculating- β_1 ones: at the *outer* boundary an annulus of relative width $b_{90}/(\rho \sin \theta)$ integrated against $d^2 \beta_1/\beta_1^2$; at the *inner* boundary the displacement can exceed the core radius $\lambda b_{90,1}$ itself, but both the centered and the displaced λ -disks carry weight $\leq \pi \lambda^2$, since the integrand is $\leq 1/b_{90,1}^2$, so that mismatch costs only $\mathcal{O}(\lambda^2)$, the order of

the core terms below) $+ \mathcal{O}(\eta/\sin^2 \theta) + \mathcal{O}(\eta^{3/4} \ln^2(1/\eta)) + \mathcal{O}(\sqrt{\eta} \ln^4(1/\eta)/\lambda^2)$ (the excised sets: on S both the true and the closed-form weights are $\leq C \sum_{\text{dyadic}} s^2/[r^2 \sin^2(\Theta_{\text{geo}}/2)] = \mathcal{O}(\eta/\sin^2 \theta)$ from the regular branch of the measure count (19), plus — for $m_* > \min(m_1, m_2)$ — $\mathcal{O}(\eta^{3/4} \ln^2(1/\eta))$ from its rainbow branch at worst-case alignment $\delta\theta \lesssim \sqrt{\eta}$, where the weights are $\leq C/b_{90}^2$ on a set of measure $\leq C b_{90}^2 \eta^{3/4} \ln^2(1/\eta)$; on N the closed-form weight is $\leq \mu(N)/(\lambda b_{90})^2$ by Lemma 7).

The core needs *no* fidelity estimate: by the energy cap of Lemma 6(i), $|\vec{y}_1| \leq C/b_{90,1}$ there, while the preimage measure of the core disk is $\pi \lambda^2 b_{90,1}^2 [1 + \mathcal{O}(K\eta/\sin^2 \theta)]$ (its boundary is the diffeomorphic image of the circle $\beta_1^* = \lambda b_{90,1}$, and the enclosed area follows from Stokes applied to the boundary parametrization; no extra preimage components exist at generic orientation because, outside S , the map is a global near-translation on the disk). Hence the true core contribution and the two-body core value $\pi \ln(1 + \lambda^2) \leq \pi \lambda^2$ are *each* $\mathcal{O}(\lambda^2)$, so replacing one by the other costs $\mathcal{O}(\lambda^2)$. Adding the annulus,

$$\boxed{\int_{\beta_1 < \rho} |\vec{y}_1|^2 d^2b = 2\pi \ln \frac{\rho}{b_{90,1}} + \mathcal{O}(\lambda^2) + \mathcal{O}\left(K(\lambda) \frac{\eta}{\sin^2 \theta} \ln^2 \frac{1}{\eta}\right) + \mathcal{O}\left(\frac{\sqrt{\eta}}{\sin \theta}\right) + \mathcal{O}\left(\frac{\sqrt{\eta}}{\lambda^2} \ln^4 \frac{1}{\eta}\right)} \quad (38)$$

and likewise about body 2 (the rainbow-excision $\mathcal{O}(\eta^{3/4} \ln^2(1/\eta))$ is absorbed in the third term, since $\eta^{3/4} \ln^2(1/\eta) \leq \sqrt{\eta}$ for η small). With $K(\lambda) \leq C\lambda^{-p}$, $p \geq 2$ (Lemma 12; larger p only weakens K , so $p \geq 2$ costs no generality), the choice $\lambda = \eta^{(1-2\alpha)/(p+2)}$ balances the first two error terms on $\sin \theta \geq \eta^\alpha$ and makes the whole error $\mathcal{O}(\eta^{c_0} \ln^4(1/\eta))$ with

$$c_0 = \min \left\{ \frac{2(1-2\alpha)}{p+2}, \frac{1}{2} - \alpha, \frac{1}{2} - \frac{2(1-2\alpha)}{p+2} \right\} > 0 \quad (p \geq 2);$$

the literal $b_{90,1}$ appears with unit coefficient and *no additive constant survives*.

Finally, the near disk's contribution to the full $|\vec{y}|^2$ differs from (38) by the cross and self-2 pieces. For the straight-line kicks themselves, Lemma 4 gives $\int_{D_1} \vec{u}_1 \cdot \vec{u}_2 = 0$ exactly and $\int_{D_1} |\vec{u}_2|^2 = \mathcal{O}(\eta/\sin^2 \theta)$. The deviations from the straight-line values split by the fate of the outgoing leg. Trajectories approaching body 2 closer than $\frac{1}{4}r_\perp$ are counted by Lemma 5: the scales $s \leq \rho$ (the set S) give (16), the scales $\rho \leq s \leq \frac{1}{4}r_\perp$ give (17) — in total $\mathcal{O}(\eta \ln^2(1/\eta)/\sin^2 \theta + \eta^{3/2} \ln^2(1/\eta)/\sin^3 \theta + \eta^{5/4} \ln^2(1/\eta))$. On the remainder the deviations are perturbative: the body-1 deflection $\chi(\beta_1) \leq C b_{90}/\beta_1$ displaces the outgoing leg at body 2 by $\leq C b_{90} r/\beta_1$, so $|\vec{y}_2 - \vec{u}_2| \leq C \min(1/r_\perp, b_{90} r/(\beta_1 r_\perp^2))$ (lever displacement against $|\nabla \vec{u}_2| \leq C/r_\perp^2$, capped by the kick magnitudes), whence $\int_{D_1} |\vec{u}_1| |\vec{y}_2 - \vec{u}_2| \leq C(b_{90} r/r_\perp^2) \ln(1/\eta) = \mathcal{O}(\eta \ln(1/\eta)/\sin^2 \theta)$; the pieces $|\vec{y}_1 - \vec{u}_1| |\vec{u}_2|$ (the $\mathcal{O}(b_{90}/\sin \theta)$ relabeling of Lemma 8 against $|\vec{u}_2| \leq C/r_\perp$) and $2|\vec{u}_2| |\vec{y}_2 - \vec{u}_2|$ are of the same or smaller order. All of this sits within the error already displayed in (38): $\eta \ln^2(1/\eta)/\sin^2 \theta$ is the second displayed term (as $K \geq 1$), $\eta^{3/2} \ln^2(1/\eta)/\sin^3 \theta = (\sqrt{\eta}/\sin \theta) \cdot \mathcal{O}(\eta^{1-2\alpha} \ln^2(1/\eta))$ on $\sin \theta \geq \eta^\alpha$, and $\eta^{5/4} \ln^2(1/\eta) \leq \sqrt{\eta}$. By Lemma 3 and the same error budget, the near disks contribute $0 + \mathcal{O}(\text{same})$ to the anisotropy $\mathcal{Y}_\perp - \mathcal{Y}_\parallel$.

5 The far region: straight lines, the upper scale, and the anisotropy

In the far region every impact parameter exceeds $\rho \gg b_{90}$, so the trajectory is a small perturbation of a straight line.

Lemma 10 (Far-region kick). *On $\{\beta_1, \beta_2 \geq \rho\}$ (generic orientation) the relative kick equals its straight-line value*

$$\vec{y}^{(0)} = \nabla_b [\ln |\vec{b} - \vec{s}_2^{\text{proj}}| - \ln |\vec{b} - \vec{s}_1^{\text{proj}}|] = \frac{\vec{b} - \vec{s}_2^{\text{proj}}}{|\vec{b} - \vec{s}_2^{\text{proj}}|^2} - \frac{\vec{b} - \vec{s}_1^{\text{proj}}}{|\vec{b} - \vec{s}_1^{\text{proj}}|^2} \quad (39)$$

(the overall sign is opposite to $\vec{y}$ as defined from $\Delta\vec{v}_1 - \Delta\vec{v}_2$; irrelevant for second moments) up to a relative error

$$\leq c \left[\frac{b_{90}}{\beta_{\min}} + \frac{b_{90} r}{\beta_1 \beta_2} \right] \leq c \frac{\sqrt{\eta}}{\sin \theta}, \quad (40)$$

where $\beta_{\min} = \min(\beta_1, \beta_2)$ (the last step uses $\beta_1 + \beta_2 \geq r_{\perp}$, so $\beta_{\max} \geq r_{\perp}/2$); for $b \gg r$ the error of the dipole is relative $\mathcal{O}(b_{90}/r)$, since the $\mathcal{O}(b_{90})$ displacement of the trajectory shifts each monopole term coherently. Consequently

$$\int_{\text{far}} (y^{(0)})^2 \text{ is convergent at large } b \text{ (dipole cancellation);} \quad (41)$$

$$\int_{\Pi_V \setminus (D_1 \cup D_2)} [(\vec{y}^{(0)})_{\perp}^2 - (\vec{y}^{(0)})_{\parallel}^2] d^2b = 2\pi + \mathcal{O}(\rho^2/r_{\perp}^2) \quad (\text{anisotropy}), \quad (42)$$

$$\int_{\beta_i \geq \rho} (\vec{y}^{(0)})^2 d^2b = 2\pi \ln \frac{r_{\perp}^2}{\rho^2} + \mathcal{O}(\rho^2/r_{\perp}^2) \quad (\text{trace, no constant}), \quad (43)$$

where $D_a = \{\beta_a < \rho\}$ are the circular near disks.

Proof. Error of the straight line. Two mechanisms contribute. *Local curvature:* a trajectory with $\beta_{\min} \geq \rho$ is deflected by total angle $\leq 2b_{90}/\beta_{\min}$ (sum of the two two-body deflections, each $\leq b_{90,i}/\beta_i$), so its transverse excursion from the straight line over the arc of the body- a encounter is $\leq cb_{90}$, a relative error $\mathcal{O}(b_{90}/\beta_{\min})$ on the kick. *Lever displacement:* the deflection $\simeq 2b_{90,\bar{a}}/\beta_{\bar{a}}$ acquired at the *other* body acts over the lever $\leq r$ separating the two passages, displacing the trajectory at the body- a encounter by $\leq 2b_{90,\bar{a}}r/\beta_{\bar{a}}$ and hence shifting the effective impact parameter there: a relative error $\leq cb_{90}r/(\beta_1\beta_2)$ on the body- a monopole. Both are $\leq c\sqrt{\eta}/\sin\theta$ because the projected bodies are $r_{\perp}$ apart, so β_1, β_2 cannot both be small: $\beta_{\max} \geq r_{\perp}/2$. (At $b \gg r$ the excursion shifts both monopole terms by the same $\mathcal{O}(b_{90})$, so the dipole error is controlled by the field *gradient*, one factor b_{90}/b better relative to each monopole, i.e. relative $\mathcal{O}(b_{90}/r)$ on the dipole.)

Convergence. For $b \gg r$, $\vec{y}^{(0)}$ is the gradient of a dipole, $|\vec{y}^{(0)}| = \mathcal{O}(r/b^2)$, so $\int (\vec{y}^{(0)})^2 b db = \mathcal{O}(\int r^2 b^{-3} db) < \infty$: no outer cutoff is needed.

Anisotropy. With $w = b_{(1)} + ib_{(2)}$ and the two bodies at real coordinates s_1, s_2 ($s_2 - s_1 = r_{\perp}$), the vector $\vec{u}_a$ corresponds to $(\bar{w} - s_a)^{-1}$ and $(y_{\perp}^{(0)})^2 - (y_{\parallel}^{(0)})^2 = \text{Re}(Y^2)$ with $Y = (\bar{w} - s_2)^{-1} - (\bar{w} - s_1)^{-1}$. Partial fractions give

$$Y^2 = \frac{1}{(\bar{w} - s_1)^2} + \frac{1}{(\bar{w} - s_2)^2} - \frac{2}{r_{\perp}} \left[\frac{1}{\bar{w} - s_2} - \frac{1}{\bar{w} - s_1} \right]. \quad (44)$$

The last bracket is absolutely integrable near each body, and by the disk identity $\int_{|w|<\Lambda} (\bar{w} - s)^{-1} d^2b = -\pi s$ (uniform-disk Cauchy transform; Λ -independent for $|s| < \Lambda$) its full-plane integral is $-\pi(s_2 - s_1) = -\pi r_{\perp}$; the excised disks change this by $\mathcal{O}(\rho \cdot \rho/r_{\perp})$. The squared self terms require care: they are only *conditionally* convergent at their singularities, and their value depends on the shape of the excision. Under excision of a *circular* disk — of any center containing the singularity — they vanish identically: $\int_{|w-c|<R, |w-s|>\epsilon} (\bar{w} - s)^{-2} d^2b = 0$, by the residue computation $\oint_{|w-c|=R} \frac{d\bar{w}}{w-s} = 0$ (the poles at $w = s$ and the double pole from $\bar{w} = \bar{c} + R^2/(w - c)$ cancel) together with the vanishing of the ϵ -circle term. This shape-dependence is not academic: excising an *ellipse* of axis ratio a/b instead leaves $-\pi(a - b)/(a + b)$ per self term ($-\pi/3$ at $a/b = 2$, i.e. 17% of the entire 2π), as one checks by the same contour computation. The decomposition of §3 uses circular disks, and the deflection map distorts their images only at $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$, so the self terms drop and $\int \text{Re}(Y^2) = (-2/r_{\perp})(-\pi r_{\perp}) = 2\pi$ up to the stated error, which is (42).

Trace. Writing $\vec{u}_a = (\vec{b} - \vec{s}_a^{\text{proj}})/\beta_a^2$ and introducing an auxiliary outer cutoff Λ , the two self terms are $\int_{\rho \leq \beta_a, |w| < \Lambda} u_a^2 = 2\pi \ln(\Lambda/\rho) + \mathcal{O}(\rho^2/r_\perp^2) + \mathcal{O}(r/\Lambda)$ each (the second error from the off-centred outer boundary, vanishing as $\Lambda \rightarrow \infty$; the first from excising the *other* body's disk), and the cross term over the full disk is $\int_{|w| < \Lambda} \vec{u}_1 \cdot \vec{u}_2 = 2\pi \ln(\Lambda/r_\perp)$ (via $\nabla^2 \ln \beta_2 = 2\pi\delta^{(2)}$ and Green's theorem), while its restriction to each near disk vanishes *exactly* by Lemma 4 — this exact vanishing is what keeps the trace bookkeeping at $\mathcal{O}(\rho^2/r_\perp^2)$ rather than the $\mathcal{O}(\sqrt{\eta})$ a term-by-term bound would give. Hence

$$\int_{\beta_i \geq \rho} (\vec{y}^{(0)})^2 = \underbrace{2(2\pi) \ln \frac{\Lambda}{\rho}}_{\text{self}} - \underbrace{2(2\pi) \ln \frac{\Lambda}{r_\perp}}_{\text{cross}} + \mathcal{O}(\rho^2/r_\perp^2) = 2\pi \ln \frac{r_\perp^2}{\rho^2} + \mathcal{O}(\rho^2/r_\perp^2),$$

the auxiliary Λ cancelling and *no* additive constant remaining, which is (43). The constant 2π lives in the anisotropy, never in the trace. $\square$

The far region thus supplies (a) the upper scale $r_\perp$ of the logarithm and (b) the entire anisotropy $\mathcal{Y}_\perp - \mathcal{Y}_\parallel = 2\pi$, both cutoff-independent, with straight-line accuracy $\mathcal{O}(\sqrt{\eta}/\sin \theta)$ near the matching circles and $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$ in the dipole bulk.

6 Assembly: proof of Theorem 1

6.1 The trace, the anisotropy, and the error tally

Fix a generic orientation. Add the two near results (38) and the far trace (43); the trace (6) is

$$\mathcal{T} = \underbrace{2\pi \ln \frac{\rho}{b_{90,1}} + 2\pi \ln \frac{\rho}{b_{90,2}}}_{\text{near 1,2}} + \underbrace{2\pi \ln \frac{r_\perp^2}{\rho^2}}_{\text{far}} + [\text{errors}] = 2\pi \ln \frac{r_\perp^2}{b_{90,1} b_{90,2}} + [\text{errors}]. \quad (45)$$

The intermediate scale ρ cancels identically, leaving the literal $b_{90,1} b_{90,2}$ and the upper scale $r_\perp^2$, with *no additive constant*. The error tally, at orientation θ with $\sin \theta \geq \eta^\alpha$ and with $\lambda = \eta^{(1-2\alpha)/(p+2)}$:

core replacement (twice)	$\mathcal{O}(\lambda^2) = \mathcal{O}(\eta^{2(1-2\alpha)/(p+2)})$
map Jacobian, speed boost $(V/V_1)^2$, $b_{90}(V_1)$, kick fidelity	$\mathcal{O}(K(\lambda) \eta \ln^2(1/\eta)/\sin^2 \theta)$
annulus/disk boundary mismatch	$\mathcal{O}(\sqrt{\eta}/\sin \theta)$
cross and self-2 contamination of the near disks	$\mathcal{O}(\eta \ln^2(1/\eta)/\sin^2 \theta + \eta^{3/2} \ln^2(1/\eta)/\sin^3 \theta + \eta^{5/4} \ln^2)$
sequential and non-dispersing excisions	$\mathcal{O}(\eta/\sin^2 \theta + \eta^{3/4} \ln^2(1/\eta) + \sqrt{\eta} \ln^4(1/\eta)/\lambda^2)$ (Lemr)
far-region straight-line error	$\mathcal{O}(\sqrt{\eta}/\sin \theta)$
far-region excised-disk terms	$\mathcal{O}(\rho^2/r_\perp^2) = \mathcal{O}(\eta/\sin^2 \theta)$

With $K(\lambda) \leq C\lambda^{-p}$, $p \geq 2$, every entry is $\mathcal{O}(\eta^c)$ for some $c = c(\alpha, p) > 0$, uniformly on $\sin \theta \geq \eta^\alpha$ (for the fourth line note $\eta^{3/2}/\sin^3 \theta \leq \eta^{3(1/2-\alpha)}$, and the rainbow entries $\eta^{5/4}, \eta^{3/4}$ — present only for $m_* > \min(m_1, m_2)$ — are already explicit powers); this proves the first display of (7). For the anisotropy, the near regions contribute 0 up to the same tally (Lemma 3 and §4.3) and the far region gives $\mathcal{Y}_\perp - \mathcal{Y}_\parallel = 2\pi + \mathcal{O}(\sqrt{\eta}/\sin \theta)$ (Lemma 10); this proves the second display. *Numerically* the whole correction is $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$ (§7); the weaker proven rate is all the constants require.

6.2 Angular and speed averages give the constants

With $\mathcal{Y}_\perp = \pi[\bar{L} + 1]$, $\mathcal{Y}_\parallel = \pi[\bar{L} - 1]$, $\bar{L} = \ln[r_\perp^2/(b_{90,1}b_{90,2})]$ and $r_\perp = r \sin \theta$, the projections of the companion paper give (Lemma 3 ensuring the longitudinal recoil is carried correctly by the trace)

$$Q_r = 2C_Q \int_0^\pi \mathcal{Y}_\perp \sin^3 \theta d\theta, \quad Q_r + 2Q_t = 2C_Q \int_0^\pi (\mathcal{Y}_\perp + \mathcal{Y}_\parallel) \sin \theta d\theta, \quad (46)$$

which are *elementary and exact*: using $\int_0^\pi \sin^3 \theta d\theta = \frac{4}{3}$, $\int_0^\pi \sin^3 \theta \ln \sin \theta d\theta = \frac{4}{3} \ln 2 - \frac{10}{9}$, $\int_0^\pi \sin \theta d\theta = 2$, $\int_0^\pi \sin \theta \ln \sin \theta d\theta = 2 \ln 2 - 2$, and the Maxwellian identity $\langle V^{-1} \ln V^4 \rangle = [\ln(4\sigma^4) - 2\gamma_E] \langle V^{-1} \rangle$ for the V -dependence of $b_{90,i} \propto V^{-2}$, one obtains exactly (5) with $\mathcal{L} = \ln[16\sigma^4 r^2/(G^2(m_1 + m_*)(m_2 + m_*))] - 2\gamma_E$. The error terms enter these averages linearly: the generic-orientation errors integrate to $\mathcal{O}(\eta^c \ln(1/\eta))$ (each $1/\sin^k \theta$ weight is tamed by the $\sin \theta$ or $\sin^3 \theta$ measure and the cone exclusion, e.g. $\int_{\sin \theta \geq \eta^\alpha} \frac{\eta \ln^2(1/\eta)}{\sin^2 \theta} \sin \theta d\theta = \mathcal{O}(\alpha \eta \ln^3(1/\eta))$); the rainbow factors $1/\sqrt{\max(\delta\theta, \cdot)}$ of Lemma 5 are integrable in θ , so those entries average to $\mathcal{O}(\eta \text{ polylog})$, and the cone contributes $\mathcal{O}(\eta^{2\alpha} \ln^3(1/\eta))$ by Lemma 6. It remains to control the speed average.

Lemma 11 (Low-speed tail). *For a Maxwellian bath, the contribution to Q_r, Q_t of speeds $V \leq V_c$, for any $V_c \leq \sigma$, is bounded by $C G^2 m_*^2 n \sigma^{-1} \cdot [(m + m_*)^2/m_*^2] (V_c/\sigma)^2$, and the closed-form integrand is bounded by the same quantity there. In particular, choosing $V_c^2 = G(m + m_*)/r$, the tail where the impulsive parameter $\eta(V) = G(m + m_*)/(rV^2)$ is not small contributes a relative $\mathcal{O}(Gm/(r\sigma^2))$ to (5), while for $V > V_c$ the fixed- V errors of §6.1, $\mathcal{O}(\eta(V)^c \text{ polylog})$, average to $\mathcal{O}((Gm/(r\sigma^2))^{c'})$ for some $c' > 0$. Hence (8) holds in the joint limit $Gm/(r\sigma^2) \rightarrow 0$.*

Proof. Energy conservation on the dispersing set gives the uniform cap $|\Delta \vec{v}| \leq CV$ (proof of Lemma 6(i)). For $b \geq B \equiv C'b_{90}(V) + 2r$ the exit-map estimate of Lemma 6(ii) ($g(\beta) \geq \beta[1 - 2b_{90}r/\beta^2] \geq \beta/2$ there, uniformly in V) keeps the pericenter above $b/4$, and the tidal-dipole estimate gives $|\Delta \vec{v}| \leq CGm_*r/(Vb^2)$, so $\int_{b>B} |\Delta v|^2 d^2b \leq CG^2 m_*^2 r^2/(V^2 B^2)$; for $b < B$ use the cap: $\int_{b<B} \leq CV^2 B^2$. Hence, for $V \leq V_c$,

$$\int |\Delta v|^2 d^2b \leq C \left[V^2 b_{90}(V)^2 + V^2 r^2 + \frac{G^2 m_*^2 r^2}{V^2 b_{90}(V)^2} \right] \leq C \frac{G^2 (m + m_*)^2}{V^2}$$

(all three terms reduce to this using $b_{90}(V) = G(m + m_*)/V^2 \geq r$ there). The V -integral of the tail is then $n \int_0^{V_c} 4\pi V^2 g V \cdot C G^2 (m + m_*)^2 V^{-2} dV = \mathcal{O}(G^2 (m + m_*)^2 n V_c^2/\sigma^3)$, which is the stated bound; the comparison with the main term $\mathcal{O}(G^2 m_*^2 n \sigma^{-1} \ln)$ gives the relative $\mathcal{O}(Gm/(r\sigma^2))$ upon inserting $V_c^2 = G(m + m_*)/r$. For $V > V_c$ the error weight $\langle V^{-1} \eta(V)^c \rangle / \langle V^{-1} \rangle = \mathcal{O}(\eta(V)^{c'})$ since $\int_0^\infty V e^{-V^2/2\sigma^2} V^{-2c} dV$ converges for $c < 1$. (In the finite window $V \in [V_c, CV_c]$, where $\eta(V)$ is no longer large but not yet small and the fixed- V lemmas do not literally apply, use the crude caps of the first part instead: the window's relative $\langle V^{-1} \rangle$ -weight is $\mathcal{O}(V_c^2/\sigma^2) = \mathcal{O}(Gm/(r\sigma^2))$, absorbed in the tail bound.) $\square$

Because the in-plane tensor is correct up to the tally of §6.1, and the averages are linear in it, the constants $-\frac{2}{3}, -\frac{8}{3}$ emerge with a vanishing correction; that is (8). $\blacksquare$

6.3 Why no constant can hide

The proof pins the constant three times over: (i) Lemma 2 fixes the close-encounter scale to the bare $b_{90,i}$ with zero additive constant (the longitudinal recoil cancels the soft-core $\sqrt{e}$); (ii) the

intermediate scale ρ cancels in (45), so no scheme scale intrudes; (iii) the anisotropy 2π is the value of a convergent integral, independent of any cutoff — provided the excisions are circular, which the decomposition guarantees and the deflection map preserves to $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$. A different multiplicative choice $b_{90,i} \rightarrow \alpha b_{90,i}$ would shift the trace $\mathcal{T}$ by the *constant* $-2\pi \ln(\alpha^2)$ and hence $Q_{r,t}$ by $-\frac{8\pi}{3}C_Q \ln \alpha^2 \neq 0$; the proof leaves no room for such a shift, and the numerics of §7 exclude it directly.

7 The surviving correction: size, sign, and interpretation

Theorem 1 establishes the limit; we now discuss the leading correction, more carefully than a single catch–phrase allows.

7.1 What survives at $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$

Three effects of the companion survive at relative order η on the near–region logarithms, and they do not all have the same sign:

- the *measure* (Jacobian) distortion of the impact–parameter relabeling, (29) — the gravitational–focusing–like compression of the beam, which *increases* the close–encounter rate;
- the *speed boost* $(V/V_1^*)^2 = 1 - \mathcal{O}(\eta)$ of (34), which multiplies the whole logarithm and *decreases* it (the encounter runs faster than the asymptotic normalization assumes);
- the shrinking of the local cutoff, $b_{90,1}(V_1^*) < b_{90,1}$, an *additive* $+\mathcal{O}(\eta)$ on the log.

The proven statement is only that their sum is within the error tally of §6.1; we do *not* claim the net correction equals the textbook focusing factor $1 + 2Gm_2/(rV^2)$ — the areal compression of a cold beam at a point is geometry–dependent, and the three effects partially cancel. What the numerics below establish is that the *net* correction is a clean $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$: positive in the configurations tested, of magnitude $\approx 2\varepsilon$ at $m_1 = m_2 = m_*$ in terms of the scale ratio $\varepsilon \equiv b_{90,1}/r$ used by the script (for equal masses $\varepsilon = 2Gm_2/(rV^2) = \frac{2}{3}\eta$), with no constant offset. Since an $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$ correction multiplying $\ln(1/\eta)$ still vanishes, the constants are untouched in the limit, as Theorem 1 states. Per trajectory, by contrast, the relabeling (28) is $\mathcal{O}(b_{90})$ — an $\mathcal{O}(1)$ fraction of the cutoff — and never becomes small; it is its area–preserving character (29) that erases it from the integral.

7.2 Direct three–body tests

Two scripts confront the proof with the exact dynamics (1).

`three_body_check.py` integrates the genuine encounter (perturber in the field of both recoiling bodies, binary internal force off), accumulates $\Delta\vec{v}_1, \Delta\vec{v}_2$, and forms the binary $\mathcal{Q}^{\alpha\beta}$ by Monte Carlo, comparing to the superposition ansatz by common random numbers. The integrator reproduces the exact two–body kick (9) in the $m_2 \rightarrow 0$ limit to $\sim 10^{-3}$. Findings: (i) per trajectory the deflection is $\mathcal{O}(1)$ and does not vanish ($\sim 25\%$ at $\beta_1 \simeq b_{90,1}$, independent of r , proportional to m_2 — the monopole relabeling (28)); (ii) in the integral it is $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$: holding V fixed and shrinking $\varepsilon = b_{90,1}/r$ ($\propto \eta$ at fixed masses), the trace enhancement $[\mathcal{Q}^\alpha_\alpha]_{3\text{body}}/[\mathcal{Q}^\alpha_\alpha]_{\text{sup}} - 1$ is

ε	0.10	0.05	0.025
enhancement	+0.209	+0.099	+0.044

halving as ε halves, positive, extrapolating to zero with no constant offset. A constant cutoff shift $b_{90} \rightarrow \alpha b_{90}$ would instead hold the *absolute* difference of the traces at the nonzero constant $-2\pi \ln \alpha^2$ (the tabulated ratio then decaying only logarithmically, not linearly); the measured difference instead falls linearly in ε and extrapolates to zero.

`deflection_map_check.py` tests the *ingredients* of the proof directly, trajectory by trajectory: (i) the pinned model yields the cutoff Gm_i/V^2 and the recoil model $G(m_i+m_*)/V^2$ (Remark 1); (ii) the displacement $|\vec{\delta}|$ is $\mathcal{O}(b_{90})$ and r -independent; (iii) the *vector* Jacobian satisfies $\det(\partial\vec{\beta}_1^*/\partial\vec{b}) - 1 = \mathcal{O}(\eta)$, halving with η ; (iv) the kick fidelity (33)–(34) holds with a small error shrinking with η , and fails if either the $(V/V_1^*)^2$ prefactor or the $b_{90,1}(V_1^*)$ shift is dropped; (v) the exact cancellation of the companion’s direct impulse (Remark 7): $|\Delta\vec{v}_1 - \Delta\vec{v}_1^{2B}|$ is measured at a few percent of $|\frac{m_*}{m_1+m_*} \int \vec{g}_2 dt|$ and falls $\propto \sqrt{\eta}$ relative to it (absolutely $\propto \eta^{3/2}$, against the direct impulse’s η), whereas subtracting the direct impulse as if it were present leaves a residual of the full $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$ size — the decomposition (33) with an additive $\int \vec{g}_2$ term would fail; (vi) the lensing caustic of Lemma 6: in the aligned configuration at $r = 200b_{90}$, a trajectory launched at $\beta \simeq \beta_E = \sqrt{2Gm_2r}/V \simeq 14b_{90}$ from the axis scores a *direct hit* on the downstream body (pericenter $< 10^{-2}b_{90}$), with $|dp/d\beta| = \mathcal{O}(1)$ across the ring — the annulus measure $\simeq 2\pi\beta_E s$ of (20), which no $\mathcal{O}(s^2)$ bound can accommodate; (vii) the rainbow fold of Lemma 5 for a heavy perturber ($m_* > m_1$): the measured lab exit angle follows (18), attains its maximum $\arcsin(m_1/m_*)$ at $\beta_{rb} = b_{90,1}\sqrt{(m_* - m_1)/(m_* + m_1)}$ with $\chi'(\beta_{rb}) = 0$ and $\chi'' \neq 0$, and the downstream miss map $g(\beta) = \beta - \ell \tan \chi(\beta)$ is non-monotone below $b_{90,1}$ while $g' \geq 1$ above it, with its Einstein zero at $\sqrt{2Gm_1\ell}/V$ — the bare lens mass, not $\sqrt{2b_{90,1}\ell}$.

8 What is proved, and what is not

Proved. (1) The exact single-body kick (9)–(10) and the self-energy identity (11): the close-encounter divergence is cut off at the *bare* $b_{90,i}$ with zero additive constant, the soft-core “ $\sqrt{e}$ ” being cancelled by the longitudinal recoil (Lemmas 1–2); the recoil of the struck body is essential (Remark 1). (2) The longitudinal recoil never enters the anisotropy, and the split of the trace between in-plane and longitudinal components is invisible to Q_r, Q_t (Lemma 3, Remark 2). (3) The near-region reduction to the two-body problem, with the deflection map and the kick fidelity proven (Lemmas 8–9) — including the exact cancellation of the companion’s direct impulse in each body’s kick (Remark 7) — the core handled by measure, the near-disk contamination handled by the harmonicity cancellation (Lemma 4) and the sequential-encounter measure estimate (Lemma 5). (4) The all-orientation exit-map measure estimate, including the Einstein-radius caustic at near-aligned orientations and the heavy-perturber ($m_* > \min m_i$) rainbow caustic of the lab-frame deflection (Lemmas 6, 5), and the dispersal estimate that excises the exchange-capture set (Lemma 7). (5) The far region gives the upper scale $r_\perp$ and the cutoff-free anisotropy 2π at straight-line accuracy, with the conditional-convergence subtlety of the self terms resolved by the circularity of the excisions (Lemma 10). (6) On assembly the intermediate scale cancels and the closed form (4)–(5), constants included, is the exact limit, including the speed average (Lemma 11); the θ - and speed-averages are exact elementary integrals.

Reduced to explicit-formula calculus. The dynamical estimates of Lemmas 8–9 rest on the quantitative regularity of the incoming leg of the Kepler flow (Lemma 12, Appendix A): uniform on $\beta \geq \lambda b_{90}$, the boundedness of the transverse-datum derivatives of the incoming leg, of the variational propagator up to its free-motion linear growth in the elapsed time, and of the osculating-element coefficients, with constants $K(\lambda) \leq C\lambda^{-p}$. The proof there is elementary calculus on

explicit conic formulas; the constants are not optimized, and the final error rate $\mathcal{O}(\eta^c)$ inherits this non-optimality. Likewise, the multi-pass channel bookkeeping in Lemma 7 is deliberately crude: only smallness far below the working accuracy is required of it, and the bound proved has a factor $\eta^{1/2}$ to spare. The numerics indicate the true rate of the surviving correction is $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$.

Established only numerically. The sharp $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$ rate of the surviving correction, its positivity in the tested configurations, and its coefficient ($\approx 2\varepsilon$, $\varepsilon = b_{90,1}/r$, for equal masses). None of these is needed for the theorem.

Outside scope. The frozen-binary approximation (A1); its $\mathcal{O}(\eta)$ adiabatic correction is a separate, equally vanishing effect. Relativistic and finite-size corrections (A2).

Conclusion. Within the impulse approximation, the close-encounter regularization is the literal $b_{90,i} = G(m_i + m_*)/V^2$, with no arbitrary multiplicative constant and no additive constant in the Coulomb logarithm. The companion paper's $\log \Lambda$ and the constants $-\frac{2}{3}, -\frac{8}{3}$ are the exact leading-order impulsive result; the corrections vanish with $b_{90}/r = \mathcal{O}((v_{\text{orb}}/V)^2)$, the impulsive parameter itself.

A Incoming-leg regularity of the Kepler flow

Lemma 12 (Kepler incoming-leg regularity). *Consider the attractive Kepler problem $\ddot{\vec{d}} = -\mu \vec{d}/|\vec{d}|^3$ with incoming asymptotic speed v and impact parameter $\beta \geq \lambda b$, $b \equiv \mu/v^2$, $\lambda \in (0, 1]$. Measure lengths in b , times in b/v . Then there are constants $K(\lambda) \leq C\lambda^{-p}$ (some finite p , computable) such that, uniformly in $\beta/b \in [\lambda, \infty)$:*

1. *the map from the transverse asymptotic datum $\vec{\beta}$, at fixed asymptotic velocity $v\hat{u}$, to the state at time t has first derivatives bounded by $K(\lambda)$, uniformly in t along the incoming leg (from the asymptote up to and including pericenter); the pericenter-state map $(\vec{\beta}, v\hat{u}) \mapsto (\vec{d}, \vec{u})(t_p)$ and its inverse are likewise $K(\lambda)$ -Lipschitz;*
2. *the transition matrices $\Phi(t, s)$ of the variational (Jacobi) equation along the orbit obey $\|\Phi(t, s)\| \leq K(\lambda)(1 + v|t - s|/b)$ on both legs; the linear growth is carried by the position rows (a perturbation tilts the asymptotic velocity, and positions then separate linearly), while the velocity rows are bounded by $K(\lambda)$;*
3. *the osculating-element coefficients $\partial X/\partial \vec{u}$ for $X \in \{E, \vec{L}, \vec{A}, \vec{\beta}, \hat{u}_{\text{in}}\}$, and their first derivatives with respect to the state, are bounded by $K(\lambda)$ times the appropriate dimensional scale ($|\vec{d}|/v$ for the lever-type entries), uniformly in time on both legs.*

Proof. (a) *The flow as a composition of explicit maps.* In units $b = 1$, $v = 1$ ($\mu = 1$), the asymptotic data determine $a = 1$ and $e = \sqrt{1 + \beta^2} \geq \sqrt{1 + \lambda^2}$, and the orbit is the hyperbolic-anomaly parametrization

$$d = e \cosh H - 1, \quad (x, y) = (e - \cosh H, \sqrt{e^2 - 1} \sinh H), \quad (\dot{x}, \dot{y}) = \frac{(-\sinh H, \sqrt{e^2 - 1} \cosh H)}{e \cosh H - 1}, \quad (47)$$

in the apse frame (x along $\hat{p}$, pericenter at $H = 0$), with the time of flight $t(H) = e \sinh H - H$ from pericenter. The apse frame itself is an explicit rotation of the asymptotic frame by the angle $\arccos(-1/e)$ about $\hat{L}$. Every map in the statement is a composition of (i) $(\vec{\beta}, v\hat{u}) \mapsto (e, \hat{p}, \hat{q})$,

explicit and smooth with all first derivatives bounded by C/λ on $\beta \geq \lambda$ (the only denominators are $\beta = \sqrt{e^2 - 1}$ and e); (ii) the formulas (47); and (iii) the inverse of the Kepler equation $H(t)$.

(b) *Inverse of the Kepler equation.* $t(H)$ is smooth and strictly increasing with $t'(H) = e \cosh H - 1 \geq e - 1 \geq c\lambda^2$, so $H(t)$ is globally smooth with $|H'(t)| \leq C\lambda^{-2}$, and each further derivative of $H(t)$, and each partial of H with respect to e at fixed t , is an explicit rational expression in $(e, \cosh H, \sinh H)$ whose denominator is a power of $e \cosh H - 1 \geq \max(e - 1, c e e^{|H| - 1} - 1)$.

(c) *Uniform bounds: what converges and what grows.* By the chain rule, every first derivative appearing in (1)–(2) is a finite sum of products of explicit rational–algebraic expressions in $(e, \cosh H, \sinh H)$ divided by powers of the three quantities that can degenerate: $e - 1 \geq c\lambda^2$, $\sqrt{e^2 - 1} \geq \lambda$, and $e \cosh H - 1 \geq e - 1$. Not every such expression stays bounded as $|H| \rightarrow \infty$: a variation that changes the orbital elements displaces late-time *positions* linearly in the elapsed time — explicitly, at fixed time from pericenter,

$$\left. \frac{\partial x}{\partial e} \right|_t = 1 + \frac{\sinh^2 H}{e \cosh H - 1} \sim \frac{d(t)}{e},$$

which is exactly the free-motion growth retained in the statement of (2). The bookkeeping is threefold. (i) The *velocity* responses converge as $|H| \rightarrow \infty$ at rate $\mathcal{O}(1/\cosh H)$: the flow straightens to free motion because the force decays as d^{-2} , integrably along the leg, and the same holds for the velocity rows of the variational (Jacobi) flow, whose fundamental solutions are explicit derivatives of (47) with respect to (e, H_0) . (ii) The *position* responses grow at most linearly, and the normalized expressions $[\text{entry}]/(1 + v|t - s|/b)$ converge at the same rate. (iii) For the transverse–datum map of (1) on the *incoming* leg the linear growth cancels: anchoring the time to the asymptote, the longitudinal Coulomb lag of the orbit is $b \ln(2d/e) + \mathcal{O}(b^2/d)$ with *unit* coefficient in b — the eccentricity enters only inside the logarithm — so a β -variation shifts the lag by the bounded amount $\partial_\beta[b \ln(2d/e)] = -b\beta/e^2$, and the position response stays bounded from the asymptote up to pericenter. Each (normalized) expression is moreover jointly continuous in $(1/e, H)$ up to the straight-line boundary $1/e = 0$. Hence $\sup_H$ is a continuous function of e on the compactified interval $e \in [\sqrt{1 + \lambda^2}, \infty]$, and the overall supremum is finite and bounded by $C\lambda^{-p}$ with p equal to twice the largest power of $(e - 1)$ occurring in any denominator — a crude count through (47) and (b) gives $p \leq 8$; only finiteness and polynomial growth in λ^{-1} are used in the text, and any $p \geq 2$ serves.

(d) *The element coefficients (3).* The coefficients $\partial X/\partial \vec{u}$ are polynomial in $(\vec{d}, \vec{u})$ divided by powers of $V_1 = \sqrt{2E}$, $|\vec{A}| = \mu e$ and $\sqrt{e^2 - 1}$, bounded below on the incoming leg by $c v$, μ and λ respectively; their state derivatives add one more power of the same denominators. The lever-type entries $(\partial \vec{\beta}/\partial \vec{u}, \partial \vec{L}/\partial \vec{u})$ carry the explicit factor $|\vec{d}|/v$ displayed in the statement; after removing it, the remaining expressions are bounded exactly as in (c), with the degenerating denominators the powers of $e - 1 \geq c\lambda^2$ already counted. $\square$

References

- [1] A. Caputo, G. M. Tomaselli and C. Hamilton, *Evolution of Binaries Under Stochastic Perturbations* (2026), to appear; verification scripts and this note at <https://github.com/gimmytomas/stochastic-binaries>.
- [2] J. Binney and S. Tremaine, *Galactic Dynamics*, 2nd ed. (Princeton, 2008), §3.1 (Rutherford scattering, b_{90}) and §8.2 (impulse approximation and its adiabatic correction); see also L. Spitzer, *Dynamical Evolution of Globular Clusters* (Princeton, 1987).